

INBRIEF



TMC(M) to support TVK-led alliance in upcoming bypoll

Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) has decided to support the TVK-led alliance in the upcoming byelections for Dharapuram and Madurantakam Assembly constituencies, party president G.K. Vasana said on Thursday. Mr. Vasana said that the alliance had given hope that the ideas of late leaders K. Kamaraj and G.K. Moopanar could be translated into making Tamil Nadu prosperous.

Expedite work at Nageswara Rao Park, says councillor

CPI(M) Councillor M. Saraswathi, citing reports in *The Hindu*, sought the early completion of Nageswara Rao Park in Mylapore. She said residents had been awaiting its reopening and drew attention to the lack of polycarbonate roofing sheets at the community pavilion.

Kanchi Math gets 5-year-old elephant from Assam

A five-year-old female elephant, Bijuli, from Assam, meant for the Kamakoti Peetam, arrived in Kancheepuram on Friday. Sources said that it was taken to Orikkai, where the pontiffs, Sri Sankara Vijayendra Saraswati Swamikal and Sri Satya Chandrashekarendra Saraswati Swamikal, are observing Chaturmasya Vrata. The elephant was garlanded and taken to the Sri Sankara Math.



Former Vice-President Venkaiah Naidu presenting Sankara Ratna Award 2025 to Prasad Reddy Katamreddy, in Chennai on Friday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Philanthropist gets Sankara Ratna Award

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Sankara Nethralaya conferred the Sankara Ratna Award 2025 on philanthropist Prasad Reddy Katamreddy, president and CEO, Twisted X Inc., Texas, and a member of the Board of Advisers, Sankara Nethralaya, the U.S., at a function here on Friday.

The award was presented by former Vice-President M. Venkaiah Naidu, in recognition of Mr. Katamreddy's support to Sankara Nethralaya, including a \$550,000 contribution towards a Mobile Eye Surgical Unit.

Accepting the award, Mr. Katamreddy dedicated the honour to the doctors and medical staff of Sankara Nethralaya. He recalled the work of the institution's founder, S.S. Badrinath, and spoke about the impact of restoring vision on an individual's dignity and independence.

Expand scope of ward funds, say councillors

They say if the first allocation of ₹30 lakh is only for pre-monsoon works, they will not be able to attend to other maintenance works. Commissioner says funds can be used for other works as well

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) councillors sought to expand the scope of works covered under the first phase of the Ward Development Fund, at the council meeting on Friday. Standing Committee Chairperson C. Velu said the councillors were asked to use the ₹30 lakh allocated for pre-monsoon works such as improving roads, cleaning storm-water drains, purchasing boats, building retaining walls, and installing CCTV cameras. If the councillors were restricted to using the fund only for the works listed, they would be unable to attend to other maintenance requirements, he said.

GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said pre-monsoon works were given priority, and that councillors could identify locations that require immediate attention.

Thiru.Vi.Ka Nagar councillor Siva. Raajashekaran said they were unable to undertake even minor works such as welding because of the restrictions on the funds.

Deputy Mayor M. Ma-



Addressing concerns: Mayor R. Priya and GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran presiding over the council meeting. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

gesh Kumaar and many councillors demanded that a revised circular be issued on the usage of funds.

Standing Committee (Revenue) Chairperson Sarbajaya Das said zonal officials had told councillors that the funds could be used only for monsoon-related works, and sought a circular clarifying the position.

Mr. Sameeran said the funds could be used for works other than monsoon preparedness and agreed to issue a circular to this effect.

Remarks draw flak Valasaravakkam Ward Committee Chairperson V. Rajan criticised certain remarks allegedly made by Minister for Public Works Department (PWD) Aad-

hav Arjuna in the Assembly during the recent Budget session on the functioning of elected representatives and DMK mayors in municipal corporations.

Mr. Rajan said councillors and committee chairpersons were not receiving adequate funds and were not being invited to meetings held by Ministers at Ripon Buildings or to inaugurations across the city.

T. Nagar BJP councillor Uma Anandan said officials of the Electricity Board, Metrowater, and the GCC did not cooperate with the councillors, and that the role of councillors was becoming redundant.

Valasaravakkam councillor S. Bharathi sought clarity on the monitoring of storm-water drain connections. Referring to the

ongoing work to lay new drains on Arcot Road, she asked whether the underground high-tension cables were being properly shifted or whether drains were being laid over them.

The Mayor said the underground cables were being shifted during excavations. Damaged or severed cables, if any, were being replaced before the work proceeded, she said.

Ms. Bharathi, however, alleged that she had submitted photographs showing lack of progress, and called for an inspection. Mr. Sameeran said the pictures had been taken during construction and that the location had since been revamped, and the high-tension cables relocated.

Four contracts awarded Tondiarpet Ward Committee chairperson Nethaji U. Ganesan said four contracts had been awarded in the past four months, including works for desilting drains and repairing damaged roads, at 34% and 36% below the estimated amounts.

Mr. Ganesan questioned the quality of such works and alleged that officials were not monitoring them regularly.



Dravidar Kazhagam leader K. Veeramani releasing the documentary and book on Maintenance of Internal Security Act. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

DMK will wait for the right moment to act, says Tiruchi Siva

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In a message to political rivals, DMK deputy general secretary Tiruchi N. Siva said his party's tolerance of "bogeyman acts" of some leaders was not to be construed as acceptance, and his party would wait for the right moment to act.

He was speaking at the release of the documentary, *The Misa Mark*, by S.K. Sridharan, here on Friday.

"We have never been afraid or have fled. We are just casually watching the bogeyman acts of some people. Tolerance is not acceptance. Tolerance does not mean we are not capable. The talented will wait for the right moment. Those are the words of [late leader] Anna. We know when to raise our arms. Then our voice will

rise and our actions will change," Mr. Siva said.

Dravidar Kazhagam leader K. Veeramani, who released the book, recalled his conversations with DMK president M.K. Stalin in prison during the Emergency.

CPI(M) leader K. Balakrishnan said the country was facing an "undeclared emergency" under the BJP government now. He hailed Karunanidhi's decision to oppose the Emergency even at the cost of the then DMK government. DMK spokesperson T.K.S. Elangovan recalled the struggles faced by the party functionaries then.

Pointing out the prolonged detention of activist Umar Khalid under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, activist and writer Thiyagu said the Emergency was still in practice, but in a different form.

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CIN U74999TN1971SGC005967

(ONLINE ONLY)

Tender Notice NIT.No.32/CD/T.No.32/2026-27 Date: 25.09.2026

For and on behalf of State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu Limited, tenders are invited under "Two Cover System" through online only for the following work from Class - III and above State level Civil Contractors registered in PWD / Highways / Any Department of Government of Tamil Nadu, Central Government Department, Tamil Nadu State Government Undertaking having experience in similar nature of works. Tenders will be received upto **15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **16.10.2026** and the same will be opened at **15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **21.10.2026**.

Name of Work	Approx. value of work	EMD
Construction of 1.00 lakh Litre OHT and 2.00 lakh Litre capacity sump with distribution pipeline system at SIPCOT Industrial Park, Thirumudavakkam.	Rs.238.32 lakhs (including GST @18%)	Rs.1,30,000 /-*

* EMD should be paid through Online in the portal (<https://tntenders.gov.in>) or through eBG as per the list of banks attached in (Annexure-III)

The tender Schedule can be Downloaded at free of cost from the website <https://tntenders.gov.in>

DIPR/2946/Tender/2026 **SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER**

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(ONLINE ONLY)

Tender Notice NIT.No.33/CD/T.No.33/2026-27 Dt.25.09.2026

For and on behalf of State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu Limited, tenders are invited under "Single Cover System" through online only for the following work from Class - IV and above state level Civil Contractors registered in PWD / Highways / Any Department of Government of Tamil Nadu, Central Government Department, Tamil Nadu State Government Undertaking having experience in similar nature of works. Tenders will be received upto **15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **21.10.2026** and the same will be opened at **15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **22.10.2026**.

Name of Work	Approx. value of work	EMD
Supply, Installation, Integration and commissioning of IP based CCTV Cameras at SIPCOT IT Park, Siruseri	Rs.130.82 Lakhs (Inclusive of GST @18%)	Rs.76,000/-*

* EMD should be paid through Online in the portal (<https://tntenders.gov.in>) or through eBG as per the list of banks attached in (Annexure-II)

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SIVANISAI MUSIC FESTIVAL - 2026

On the occasion of 136th Birthday Celebrations of Brahmin Papanasam Sivan Today at Sathguru Gnanananda Hall, Narada Gana Sabha.

3.00 PM - Vocal Concert by Vid.Raghu Vellal with Vid. Siva Teja, Vid.Kishore Ramesh and Vid.Madipakkam Murali.

5.00 PM - "Sri Kapaleswarar Pancharatnam" A Tribute to Brahmin Papanasam Sivan composed by Dr.Rukmini Ramanji-Group rendition by Vidvans and Vidushis.

6.00 PM - "Andal Charitham" by HH "Sri Sankara Vijayendra Saraswathi Swamikal" Inauguration and Presentation of prizes to the winners of Papanasam Sivan competitions including Tambura Prizes instituted in memory of Smt.Narayanaammal Vaidyasekaramia Iyer. Chief Guest: Sri Anush Rajan, Director, Ministry of Culture, Govt of India, New Delhi.

Guest of Honour: Cleveland Sri.V.Sundaram, Co-Founder, Cleveland Thyagaraja Aradhana Festival

7.15 PM - "Andal Charitham" - Dance Drama production composed by Brahmin Papanasam Sivan and presented by Kalakshetra Foundation. Master of Ceremony:Smt.Revathy Sankaran Main Sponsor: Lanco Holdings Limited. Co-Sponsors: COSMO, Kalpataru Doors and Plywood, Kone Elevators & Escalators, Mangal Tiru, Netraj & Venkat Architects and Roca.

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E-TENDER NOTICE NO. Dy.CEE-PS-MLG-HQ-TR-26-27, dated, 22-09-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work: **Tender No.:** Dy.CEE-PS-MLG-HQ-TR-26-27; **Name of work:** (i) Part A: Provision of Online monitoring & control of electrical assets over Maligaon area of Maligaon (HQ) Unit, (ii) Part B: Comprehensive Annual maintenance Contract (CAMC) of IoT devices for monitoring electrical general assets for a period of 08 (Eight) years in IR-NIYANTRAC. **Advised Value:** ₹1,99,55,382/- **Earnest Money:** ₹3,99,100/- **E-tender will be closed at 15:00 hrs. on 14-10-2026.** For details please visit: www.ireps.gov.in Dy.CEE/PS/Maligaon/HQ **NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY** "Serving Customers with a smile"

Water hyacinth remains a challenge as WRD steps up monsoon readiness

Residents call for permanent steps to stop sewage pollution; nearly 50% of the work to clear waste from waterways, waterbodies has been completed: officials

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

The Water Resources Department (WRD) has expedited work to clear clogged waterways in the city ahead of North-east monsoon. However, large swathes of water hyacinth remain a challenge.

According to the WRD, nearly 50% of the works, being carried out at a cost of ₹42 crore, has been completed so far. The annual exercise aims at clearing floating waste, debris, and large stretches of aquatic weeds in various major and minor waterways and water bodies in the city, its surrounding districts, and Cuddalore district.

Of the total 528.44 km of waterways in five districts, nearly 104.74 km of waterways lie within the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) limits. The department has deployed about 400 machines to clean the waterways, including Adyar, Cooum, Kosasthalaiyar, and Araniyar rivers and Buckingham Canal.

The first phase of desilting work would be completed by October first week. This would help minimise floods in rivers and backflow into micro drains by 70% to 80% during monsoon. “The rivers would be able to handle the flows without spillover even



For smooth flow: Work in progress to clear sand bars at the Adyar river mouth on Friday as part of monsoon preparedness works . B. VELANKANNI RAJ

in the event of 200 mm of rainfall in a day,” an official said. Work is also being carried out to clear sand bars at the river mouths of the Adyar, Cooum, Araniyar, Muttukadu-Kovalam estuary, and Pudupattinam sea mouth. The department is carrying out controlled opening of the river mouths to prevent seawater intrusion and ensure smooth tidal flow, officials said. The monsoon preparedness works would be carried out in coordination with GCC and local bodies till the year end.

Flood vulnerability
According to the department's flood vulnerability assessment, the proportion of flood-hazard areas and population density were moving from the outer Chennai Metropolitan Area areas towards the GCC urban region.

Residents stressed the need for permanent solutions to

prevent sewage pollution in waterbodies and waterways, rather than relying solely on periodic cleaning.

K. Mohan, a rower and Thiruvannmiyur resident, said Adyar river has undergone some restoration efforts, including tree cover along the riverbanks and widening the river near the creek. The authorities must periodically remove the accumulated floating waste near the trash booms like in Nandanam.

Residents also urged the authorities to ensure culverts are cleared of water hyacinth for free flow of floodwater during the rainy season.

Geetha Ganesh of AGS Colony, Velachery, said Velachery Lake and Veerangal Odai must be desilted to increase capacity. Sewage flow must be arrested to prevent vegetation and ensure ground-water recharge.

No evidence so far of child sexual abuse at government school, say Tambaram Police

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tambaram Police are investigating alleged child sexual abuse reported at a government school near Vandalur in Chengalpattu district on Thursday.

The police have registered an FIR and initiated an investigation by a woman Inspector, under the supervision of senior women police officers. The police examined CCTV footage from the school and surrounding areas, conducted a medical examination of the child, and recorded detailed statements from witnesses. They also scrutinised scientific and other corroborative evidence available.

The police said that no material has emerged at this stage to establish that the alleged incident took place inside the government school. The police have appealed to the public not to circulate unverified information, keeping in mind the interests of the child.

Expressing shock over the incident, Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin accused the TVK-led government of attempting to cover up the incident as a snakebite. He alleged that the girl was abducted from the school premises by some unidentified persons and sexually assaulted.

“Where is the Singapenn Special Force? Where is the Chief Minister who delivered dialogues saying he would be like an elder brother when it

comes to women's safety and protect them? It is a shame that the students are not safe even within the government school premises under the dummy Chief Minister's circus government, which claims no compromise on women's safety,” Mr. Udhayanidhi asked in a post on X.

He also accused the police of trying to cover up the crime and divert the issue by portraying it as a snakebite. He claimed this was being done as the Chief Minister was to visit Madurantakam for the bypoll campaign.

Mr. Udhayanidhi further alleged that the police had seized the mobile phones of the girl's parents and “threatened” them not to reveal the incident in public. He said that if there was any attempt to cover up this incident in view of the upcoming bypoll, “the people would certainly teach the rulers a lesson”.

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami, in a post on social media, pulled up Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay over the incident and the way he ran the Police Department. He also criticised the police for allegedly directing media organisations to delete any news item regarding the incident.

AMMK founder T.T.V. Dhinakaran said Mr. Vijay becoming the Chief Minister was a “curse” on Tamil Nadu, as, he alleged, Mr. Vijay was keen on campaigning for the bypolls instead of taking steps to initiate follow-up action for the incident.

Man gets double life term for sexually assaulting woman

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Principal District and Sessions Court in Tiruvallur has sentenced a 28-year-old man to double life imprisonment and 16 years of rigorous imprisonment for sexually assaulting a 54-year-old woman near Uthukottai in January 2025.

The incident took place when Poongodi went to visit her daughter in Chennankarani village on Ja-

nuary 6, 2025. According to the prosecution, the accused, Raja, sexually assaulted her in an isolated spot near the house.

The Uthukottai All-Women Police registered a case and arrested Raja. The trial was conducted before the Tiruvallur court, with J. Jai-ganesh for the prosecution. After examining the evidence, the court on Friday held Raja guilty, sentenced him to prison, and also imposed a fine of ₹1.25 lakh.

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Man hacked to death over property dispute, 5 held

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 50-year-old man, Palani, was hacked to death over a property dispute by a five-member gang in Kolapakkam near Mangadu on Thursday evening. The police have arrested Palani's nephew Balaji and four of his associates – Murali, Vetrimaran, Dhanush, and Pari Venkat. Police said Palani was attacked by the gang while he was chatting with his friends near his house. Further probe is on.

Timings			
CHENNAI			
SATURDAY, SEP. 26			
 RISE	05:58	SET	18:03
 RISE	17:45	SET	05:24
SUNDAY, SEP. 27			
 RISE	05:58	SET	18:02
 RISE	18:25	SET	06:16
MONDAY, SEP. 28			
 RISE	05:59	SET	18:01
 RISE	19:09	SET	07:10

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Chennai City	34	25

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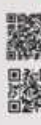
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Dr. G. Viswanathan
Founder & Chancellor



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CM YK  A CH-CHE

PM Modi likely to inaugurate Poonamallee-Vadapalani Metro Rail stretch on Oct. 11

The opening of this stretch will be a relief to commuters. However, the stations from Alapakkam to Saligramam, which are situated between Porur and Vadapalani, are still under construction

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

After months of waiting, Prime Minister Narendra Modi is likely to inaugurate the Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch of Chennai Metro Rail's Phase II project on October 11, sources said. He is also expected to take a train ride from Poona-



Much-awaited nod: The 14.6-km Phase II stretch, from Poonamallee to Vadapalani via Porur, received the final approval from the Commissioner of Railway Safety in May. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Other projects
Mr. Modi would board the train at Poonamallee and alight at Porur station. Sources said the Prime Minister might also visit IIT-Madras, and there would be another public function where he would inaugurate various projects, including the Vellore airport, and lay the foundation for

more projects.
In the initial phase, a train would be available every 10 minutes on the Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch and about 15 trains were likely to be put to use for operations. The first stretch of the 118.9-km phase II project from Poonamallee to Porur, a section of Corridor 4 (Poona-

mallee to Light House), was slated for completion in December 2025. Then, Chennai Metro Rail began work to improve connectivity to Vadapalani station so commuters could switch to the Phase I network at this station. The works were slated for completion in February 2026. But the 14.6-km stretch,

from Poonamallee to Vadapalani via Porur, received the final approval from the Commissioner of Railway Safety (CRS) only in May this year.

The opening of this stretch will be a much-needed relief to commuters, as they can finally skip heavy congestion on Arcot Road and travel by Metro Rail from Poonamallee to Vadapalani. However, till now, Chennai Metro Rail continues to construct the stations from Alapakkam to Saligramam (situated between Porur and Vadapalani). It is still not clear when these stations will be open to the public. Many commuters have been constantly questioning the inordinate delay in the opening of the Poonamallee-Vadapalani Metro Rail stretch, and when it would be inaugurated.

50th Chennai Book Fair to be held from Jan.7 to 19

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar unveiled a logo and website for the 50th Chennai Book Fair on Friday.

The Golden Jubilee edition of the Chennai Book Fair, to be organised by Booksellers and Publishers Association of South India (BAPASI), would be held from January 7 to 19, 2027, at YMCA Grounds in Nandanam.

Mr. Prabhakar noted that those who frequented the city's 162 libraries the most this year, could be identified and the top three visitors may be given prizes.

R.S. Shanmugam, president of BAPASI said the government granted ₹1 crore to organise the Golden Jubilee event of the book fair and a Government Order was also passed in this regard. Layola Mani, chairman of the Tamil Nadu Textbook and Educational Services Corporation and M. Kavitha, district library officer, Chennai, also spoke. The website for the book fair this year is www.chennaibookfair.com.

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
CORRIGENDUM
Tender No.: 75265010, Dated: 22/09/2026. The following Corrigendum against Tender No. 75265010 scheduled to be open on 23.11.2026 at 11:00 hrs. is carried out as follows: Sl. No.: [1]. Particulars: 1st Pre-Bid Conference Date and Time. As per Tender Document: Existing. To Be Read As: 30.09.2026, 11:00 hrs.
PR3/499 AMM (M)/CLW/Chittaranjan
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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
For and on behalf of The President of India, Assistant Electrical Engineer (Construction), South Eastern Railway, Ranchi Division invites e-tender for the following tender has been uploaded on website below mention The tender will be closed at 12:00 Hrs on due date, e-Tender Notice No.: EL-CON-RNC-ELS-26-4; Closing Dated: 16.10.2026. Brief Description of Works : Supply, erection, testing & commissioning of 25KV OHE electrification and modification works at HTE Electric Loco Trip Shed including General Services work in connection with the Construction of new Electric Loco Trip Shed at Hatia in Ranchi Division of South Eastern Railway. Value of Work: ₹2,22,81,631.10/-; Bid Security: ₹4,45,600/- & Completion Period: 18 Months. Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in [E-Tender →Works (login with phone no.) and search with above mentioned tender no.] for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. NB: "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit our website to participate in all other tenders." (PR-813)

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BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture, Mahadevapura / K.R. Pura Zone, Vengalahaan Lake ECO Park, K.R. Pura, Bengaluru-560036.
No: SADH(S)/TENDER/201/2026-27 Date: 25-09-2026
INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT) - (SHORT TERM)
(Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal only)
The Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture (Mahadevapura / K.R. Pura Zone), BECC, Bengaluru (Referred to as Employer in these documents) invites Tenders to Implement Works in accordance with KPPP Rules 2000, from eligible and experienced Person / Agencies / Firms (Referred to as Tenderers in these documents) registered in Labour Department for Development of Parks.
(Standard Tender Document - KW-3)
Sl. No. Name of the Work
1 Beautification and Landscape Development, with Borewell Drilling and Other Civil Works in A. Narayanapura Bande Park (West Side) in Ward No. 20, K.R. Pura Constituency. Amount Put to Tender (Excluding GST) (in Rs.): 1,50,00,000/-, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 2,25,000/-
Calendar of Events: 1) Tender documents can be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from 28-09-2026. 2) Last Date for Queries: 03-10-2026. 3) Date of Pre Bid Meeting: 03-10-2026. 4) Date of Tender Closing: 06-10-2026. 5) Date of Opening of Technical Bid: 08-10-2026. 6) Date of Opening of Financial Bid: After Approval of Technical Bid. Further details can be had from the above office.
Sd/- Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture Mahadevapura / K.R. Pura Zone, BECC.

Government of Odisha
Office of Special Relief Commissioner
CORRIGENDUM
No. 5243 / R&DM(DM), Dt. 24.09.2026
In continuation of the Notice No.4797/R&DM(DM), Dt.02.09.2026 regarding Inviting Expression of Interest (EOI) issued by the Office of the Special Relief Commissioner, Government of Odisha, for Selection of Agency for Establishment, Upgradation, Integration, Operation and Maintenance of Early Warning Dissemination System (EWDS) in the State, the last date for submission of EOI is hereby extended as follows:
Existing last date for submission of EOI: 25th September, 2026 by 15:00 Hrs
Revised last date for submission of EOI : 3rd October, 2026 by 15:00 Hrs
All other terms and conditions of the EOI shall remain unchanged.
Sd/-
Special Relief Commissioner
24001/475/2627 OIPR-24001/24003/1/26-27/0004

ODISHA CONSTRUCTION CORPORATION LIMITED
BHUBANESWAR, ODISHA, PIN:751012, Tel No.(0674) 2562020,
e-Mail : theoccltd@odishaconstruction.com
GSTIN - 21AAAC02571K2ZM
***e*-Procurement Notice No. 15 /OCCL/2026-27 (on-line)**
On-line percentage rate tender is invited for the following work :
Sl. No. Name of Work Bid Identification No. Approx. Value of work (Rs. in Lakhs) Bid Security (through on-line transfer / as per DTCN) (in Rs.) Period of Completion Availability of Tender (on-line)
01 Integrated Development of Hirakud Reservoir & its surroundings- Dam Museum- Interiors & Fit-Out OCCL-SMP/01/2026-27 Rs.1999.61 Lakhs Rs.20,00,000/- 06 (Six) Calendar months From 29.09.2026, 3.30 PM to 21.10.2026, 5.30 PM.
Procurement Officer : Managing Director, OCCL
Date of Opening of the Technical Bid : 22.10.2026, 12.00 Noon onwards.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal : <https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in>
MANAGING DIRECTOR
34001/880/2627 OIPR-34001/34120/1/26-27/0016

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
Viniyamak Bhawan, C-Block, Shivalik, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi – 110 017
Fax No. : 41080416, 41080417

RECRUITMENT NOTICE
DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION (DERC) invites applications to fill the following key leadership & administrative positions through **Deputation Basis** only:

S. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Posts	Pay Level (7th CPC)	Pay Scale
1	Secretary	01	Level-14	₹1,44,200–2,18,200
2	Executive Director (Tariff)	01	Level-14	₹1,44,200–2,18,200
3	Executive Director (Engg.)	01	Level-14	₹1,44,200–2,18,200
4	Executive Director (Law)	01	Level-14	₹1,44,200–2,18,200
5	Joint Director (Tariff –Finance)	01	Level-13	₹1,23,100–2,15,900
6	Joint Director (Law)	01	Level-13	₹1,23,100–2,15,900
7	Dy. Director (Tariff – Economics)	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
8	Dy. Director (Tariff) –Accounts & Finance Analysis	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
9	Dy. Director (Law)	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
10	Joint Secretary	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
11	Dy. Director (Consumer Assistance)	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
12	Principal Private Secretary	02	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
13	Dy. Director (Info – Tech)	01	Level-11	₹67,700–2,08,700
14	Asstt. Director (Info –Tech)	02	Level-10	₹56100 -177500
15	Assistant Account Officer	01	Level-8	₹47600-151100
16	Personnel Officer	01	Level-8	₹47600-151100

For further details, such as eligibility, qualifications, experience and other terms & conditions of appointment including compensation, facilities etc. please refer to DERC website link <https://www.derc.gov.in/regulations/management-and-development-human-resources-regulations> and for submitting the application <https://www.derc.gov.in/app/home/openings>

The last date for submission of application is 26.10.2026. For any query/clarification please contact:

Prashasti De,
Dy. Director (Pers.) DERC
Email id:hrdivderc@gmail.com

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0229/26-27

Tel: 011-41080414

BENGALURU SMART INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED (B-SMILE)
Office of the Project Engineer-02, No. 30/1, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru-560051
No: B-SMILE/PE-02/TEND/04/2026-27/CORRIGENDUM-2 Date: 25.09.2026
CORRIGENDUM-2
(Addendum issued under Clause 2.9 of the RFP)
Ref: 1. Notice Inviting Tender No. B-SMILE/PE-02/TEND/04/2026-27 dated 17.08.2026.
2. Request for Proposal (RFP) for the Project- Clause 1.3 (Schedule of Bidding Process), Clause 2.9 (Amendment of RFP) and Clause 6.2(b).
3. Corrigendum-1 No. B-SMILE/PE-02/TEND/04/2026-27/CORRIGENDUM-1 dated 08.09.2026.
4. As per Approval of Competent Authority Vide no. e-278639 Dated: 24.09.2026.
Sub: Construction of Elevated Corridor from Marenahalli Main Road (Ragigudda junction) to Kanakapura Main Road via BWSSB Pipeline Road (Thalaghattapura junction) in Bengaluru City on BOOT (Toll) Mode - Dynamic Duration - Extension of the date for the Authority's response to pre-bid queries and of the Bid Due Date- Corrigendum-2- reg.
In exercise of the powers reserved to the Authority under Clause 2.9 (Amendment of RFP) read with Clause 6.2(b) of the RFP, and in order to afford prospective Bidders reasonable time to take into account the Authority's responses to the pre-bid queries and the revised Bidding Documents issued therewith, and to encourage wider participation in the Bidding Process, the Schedule of Bidding Process at Clause 1.3 of the RFP as revised by Corrigendum-1 dated 08.09.2026, and the corresponding Calendar of Events notified in the Notice Inviting Tender under reference, are hereby further revised as under:

Sl. No.	Event Description	Existing Date / Time	Revised Date / Time
1	Invitation of RFP (NIT)	17.08.2026 @ 4:00 p.m.	No change
2	Date and time for availability of tender documents in KPP Portal	20.08.2026 @ 4:00 p.m.	No change
3	Last date for submission of pre-bid queries	01.09.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.	No change
4	Date and time of pre-bid meeting	02.09.2026, 3:00 p.m. @ B-SMILE HQ	No change (meeting held)
5	Authority response to pre-bid queries latest by	11.09.2026 upto 4:00 p.m.	05.10.2026 upto 4:00 p.m.
6	Bid due date (Last date & time for receipt of tenders)	14.10.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.	05.11.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.
7	Physical submission of bid security / power of attorney etc.	14.10.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.	05.11.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.
8	Date & time of opening of technical bid	15.10.2026	06.11.2026
9	Declaration of eligible / qualified bidders	16.11.2026	30.11.2026
10	Opening of Financial bid	Will be notified	Will be notified
11	Letter of Award (LOA)	15.12.2026	Will be notified
12	Validity of bid	180 days from bid due date	180 days from the revised bid due date, i.e. up to and including 04.05.2027
13	Signing of Concession Agreement	Within 45 days of award of LOA	No change

This Corrigendum is published on the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (<https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>) in terms of the Notice Inviting Tender.
Sd/-
Project Engineer-2
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited (B-SMILE)

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH
The Sharma Centre for Heritage Education (SCHE) Deeply Mourns the Passing of

Dr. Kumar Akhilesh
(D.O.B: 05.01.1975 - D.O.D: 25.9.2026)
our Director, Colleague, Mentor and Friend, whose remarkable contributions to Indian prehistoric archaeology and heritage education will be remembered with great respect. We extend our heartfelt condolences to his family, colleagues, students and all who had the privilege of knowing him.
Phone: 8087810331

DEATH
IN LOVING MEMORY OF

Mrs. SHYAMALA PANICKER
04-12-1939 - 22-09-2026
Resident of Anna Nagar, Chennai, joined the light on 22-09-2026 in Hong Kong, surrounded by those who loved her.
Last rites and cremation will be held in Hong Kong on 26-09-2026.
Her life will be remembered and revered, having touched and helped so many around her. Praying for her soul's journey in the light and her Mukthi. Om Shanti.
Deeply missed by her sons
Prakash, Murali, Karunakaran, and family

DEATH
OBITUARY

Smt. THIRUMULU NATARAJAN
W/o Late Sri. K.V. Natarajan Iyer, Kadiramangalam Attained Heavenly Abode on Friday 25th September 2026.
Deeply mourned by: Son & Daughter-in-law, Daughter & Son-in-law, Grandchildren and Great Grandchildren.
Ph: 9840415008

BIRTHDAY REMEMBRANCE
Birthday Remembrance

K. V. BALU
Fondly remembered by Govind, Vandhana, Haritha and Keshav

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
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DEATH ANNIVERSARIES
REMEMBRANCE

Sri. B KUMAR M.A., D.P.T. Assistant Engineer (Printing), The Hindu "You are always in our Heart"
Wife: Chitra Devi.A Son: Dr. Arvind. K. Ph: 80150 84527

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES
First Year Death Anniversary

S.R. RADHAKRISHNAN, M.A.(S.W)
Retd. Zonal Director, Ministry of Labour, Govt. Of India.
A social worker by education, an entrepreneur at heart, a progressive in his home and a farmer in his soul.
You have planted a seed in each one of us which will live on forever.
Deeply missed and remembered by Ravi, Madhan, Manju, Sushma, Uma, Suren, Shruti, Shreya, Shweta, Darshan, Arjun and the rest of your family, relatives, friends & employees of **JANATHA TRANSPORT** Selamanatham, Vellore, 632319



Today, Bharat is the third-largest solar power-generating nation in the world. Our non-fossil fuel energy capacity has tripled. Bharat was the first G20 country to meet the Paris Agreement goals ahead of schedule.

Shri Narendra Modi, Prime Minister



Foundation Stone

Laying Ceremony

150 TPD e-METHANOL PLANT

In Deendayal Port Authority, Kandla

An Initiative Towards India's Green Energy Transition

Assam Petro-Chemicals Limited, Namrup, Assam & Deendayal Port Authority (DPA), Kandla, Gujarat



11 AM on 26 September 2026



DPA Exhibition Ground, Gandhidham, Gujarat



KEY FEATURES

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU



150 TPD capacity – among India's largest e-Methanol facilities



₹2,300 crore investment, structured as scalable modules in phases



Located at Deendayal Port Authority, Kandla – on India's busiest western trade route



Fuels ships on the Singapore–Rotterdam corridor, positioning India as a global green-fuel supplier, not just a buyer



Brings together Assam's industrial strength (APCL) and Gujarat's port gateway (DPA)



Jobs at home – over 3,500 direct and indirect jobs for youth, engineers and skilled workers



Cleaner air, cleaner seas – less dependence on imported fossil fuel, less pollution from shipping



A more self-reliant India – every tonne of e-Methanol made here is a tonne we don't import



Stronger local economy – new industry, new business for transporters, suppliers and traders around Kandla



National pride – India moves from being a fuel importer to a fuel exporter for the world's ships

Foundation Stone to be laid by

Shri Bhupendra Patel

Hon'ble Chief Minister of Gujarat

Shri Sarbananda Sonowal

Hon'ble Union Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways, Government of India

Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma

Hon'ble Chief Minister of Assam

In august presence of

Shri Shantanu Thakur

Hon'ble Minister of State for Ports, Shipping & Waterways

Shri Vinod Chavda

MP Kachchh, Gujarat

Smt. Maltiben Kishor Maheshwari

MLA, Gandhidham

Shri Vijay Kumar, IAS

Secretary
Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways

Shri Bikul Deka

Chairman
Assam Petro-Chemicals Ltd (APCL)

Shri Sushil Kumar Singh, IRSME

Chairman
Deendayal Port Authority (DPA)

Shri Hemanta Gogoi

Vice Chairman, APCL



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INBRIEF



Security strengthened ahead of Sabarimala pilgrimage

Keralam Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala has said that extensive arrangements will be put in place to ensure the safety of pilgrims during the upcoming Sabarimala pilgrimage. The Minister chaired a high-level meeting on Friday to review preparations by the police. He said that social media campaigns would be organised in regional languages while signboards and public announcement systems would be installed at key locations to provide information to pilgrims.

Karnataka set to launch adventure tourism initiative

With the aim of providing sports enthusiasts a platform to participate in adventure sports while exploring various tourism destinations, the Karnataka Tourism Department will launch ‘Active Karnataka - Run, Ride, Surf and Explore’ on September 27 on the occasion of World Tourism Day. The Tourism department will enter into an agreement with leading sports event organisers and connect them with nearby tourism destinations.

ED summons Telangana MLA in money-laundering probe

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has summoned Telangana’s Serilingampally MLA Arekapudi Gandhi for questioning, as part of its money-laundering probe into Sahiti Infratec Ventures India Private Limited (SIVPLI). Around ₹2.1 crore from the company was allegedly found to have been routed through the MLA’s bank accounts. The ED issued summons asking Mr. Gandhi to appear before the agency on Monday.

Keralam urges Centre to limit eco-sensitive areas to forests

State govt. submits recommendations seeking resetting of ESA in Western Ghats; populated areas, farmlands and plantations should be excluded from the notification, says Minister

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam government has urged the Centre to limit the Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA) in its Western Ghats region to forest areas covering 8,590.69 sq. km.

M.G. Rajamanickam, Special Secretary, Environment and Climate Change, formally placed the State’s recommendations and suggestions before the Centre on Thursday, Minister for Electricity and Environment Sunny Joseph said in Thiruvananthapuram on Friday. “Our stand is that populated areas, farmlands and plantations should be excluded and the ESA limited to forest re-



A view of the Kootickal village in Kottayam district, which has been included in the draft ESA notification. VISHNU PRATHAP

gions,” Mr. Joseph said.

In 2013, the K. Kasturirangan Committee had proposed an ESA of 13,108 sq. km covering 123 villages in the State. This had sparked widespread protests. Following a study, the Union Ministry of Environ-

ment and Forests had issued a draft notification that reduced the area to 9,993.7 sq. km. The State wants the ESA to be brought down to 8,590.69 sq. km and the number of villages to 98.

If needed, Chief Minis-

ter V.D. Satheesan will lead a delegation to New Delhi to press the State’s case, said the Minister, adding that Keralam is seeking a final notification from the Centre as all notifications issued from 2014 to July 2026 have been drafts.

‘Unique’ case

Keralam’s case was “unique” given its small size but dense population and large forest cover (29.15% of total area), he said. The addition of another law to the existing stringent laws protecting the forest, environment, paddy fields and wetlands could adversely affect the State’s development, agriculture and the everyday life of the people, the Minister added.

EC rejects BJP MLA’s plea to scrutinise 2,598 votes in Karnataka constituency

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI

The Election Commission of India (EC) officials in charge of the special intensive revision (SIR) have rejected BJP leader and MLA Abhay Patil’s demand for scrutiny and deletion of around 2,598 votes in Karnataka’s Belagavi North constituency.

M. Karthik, Belagavi City Corporation Commissioner and the Electoral

Registration Officer (ERO) has replied to the MLA’s letter, saying that there was no legal provision for bulk scrutiny or deletion of votes under the SIR process. He, however, clarified that Booth Level Agents (BLAs) could file objections to the inclusion of doubtful electors through the Booth Level Officers (BLOs).

In a letter dated September 19, Mr. Patil had alleged that BLAs from his constituency had identified over

2,598 suspected bogus voters. He had submitted details of the suspected voters, along with their part numbers and booth numbers, and sought scrutiny of their entries.

B.K. Hariprasad, MLC and KPCC president, had objected to Mr. Patil’s move, arguing that the MLA had no *locus standi* to write to SIR officials seeking bulk deletion of voters. He alleged that the MLA was targeting Muslim vo-

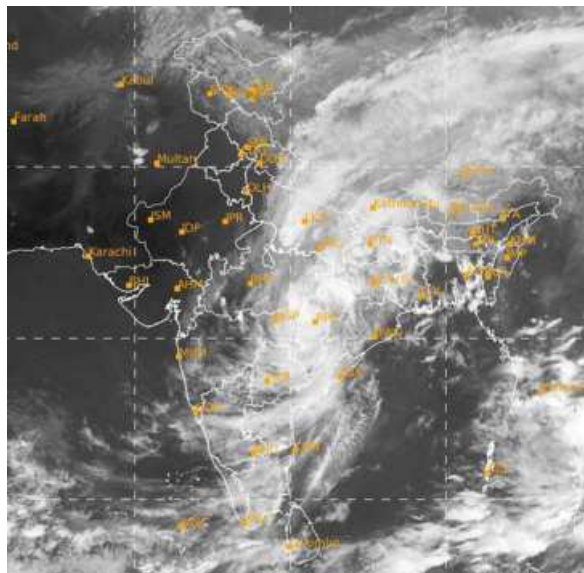
ters to further his prospects in the next election.

Speaking to reporters in Belagavi on Friday, Mr. Patil said he had not sought bulk deletion of voters.

“I have not asked for deletion of the names of any elector. I am only asking SIR officers to look into allegations of inclusion of bogus voters, scrutinise Forms 6 and 7 submitted by suspect voters and delete their names if found false...,” he said.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Saturday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha and Chhattisgarh. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Keralam and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		35.0.....	25.7	Kurnool		33.6.....	25.6
Ahmedabad		34.3.....	26.2	Lucknow		15.2.....	23.5.....
Aizawl		5.7.....	32.5.....	Madurai		35.0.....	24.6
Bengaluru		27.9.....	20.9	Mangaluru		52.8.....	29.2.....
Bhopal		30.2.....	20.9	Mumbai		32.0.....	27.8
Bhubaneswar		41.5.....	28.9.....	Mysuru		29.0.....	20.0
Chandigarh		32.0.....	26.0	New Delhi		33.0.....	24.2
Chennai		37.2.....	28.4	Patna		39.8.....	27.3.....
Coimbatore		31.6.....	23.0	Port Blair		12.....	30.7.....
Dehradun		5.4.....	29.9.....	Prayagraj		31.8.....	25.4.....
Gangtok		46.4.....	15.9.....	Puducherry		36.4.....	27.8
Goa		4.4.....	32.0.....	Pune		32.0.....	22.2
Guwahati		33.7.....	25.1	Raipur		77.3.....	24.9.....
Hubballi		30.0.....	22.0	Ranchi		41.....	23.9.....
Hyderabad		31.5.....	24.6	Shillong		24.8.....	17.5
Imphal		31.3.....	19.8	Shimla		24.8.....	17.0
Jaipur		31.6.....	23.8	Srinagar		27.9.....	12.4
Kochi		36.....	31.0.....	Thiruvananthapuram		0.8.....	31.0.....
Kohima		29.0.....	16.6	Tiruchirappalli		36.1.....	26.6
Kolkata		32.7.....	31.7.....	Vijayawada		73.....	32.4.....
Kozhikode		1.4.....	31.8.....	Visakhapatnam		24.1.....	31.0.....

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing	Yesterday
CITIES	SO₂ PM₁₀ PM_{2.5} PM₁₀ CODE
Ahmedabad	27 26 33 105 135
Bengaluru	24 22 27 23 44
Chennai	6 10 25 57 102
Delhi	9 37 42 45 134
Hyderabad	13 24 53 49 79
Kolkata	6 30 37 34 33
Lucknow	3 17 30 34 29
Mumbai	29 9 25 51 60
Pune	15 24 50 63 107
Visakhapatnam	18 34 20 50 77

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

BRIC-National Agri-Food and Biomanufacturing Institute
(Formerly National Agri-Food Biotechnology Institute & Center of Innovative & Applied Bioprocessing)
(Deptt. of Biotechnology, Ministry of Science & Technology, Govt. of India)
Knowledge City, Sector-81, Mohali

RECRUITMENT NOTICE
BRIC-National Agri-Food and Biomanufacturing Institute (formerly National Agri-Food Biotechnology Institute & Center of Innovative and Applied Bioprocessing) is an autonomous Institute under the Department of Biotechnology, Government of India. This futuristic innovation institute of its own kind in the country has a mission of advancing knowledge, leads and emerging technologies/processes relevant to Agri-food & Biomanufacturing sector towards applications and products.
BRIC-NABI invites applications from Indian Citizens for filling up the **Administrative position** on Direct Recruitment basis, as mentioned below:-

Administrative Position				
[Advt. No. NABI/ADMIN/1/(001)/2026-03/Rectt.]				
Sr. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post & Category	Age Limit	Level as per 7 th CPC
1.	Management Assistant	01 (UR)	30 Years	Level-6 (₹ 35,400- ₹ 1,12,400)

*Age relaxation shall be as per the Government of India (GOI) norms.
The detailed advertisement and procedure for submitting the online application are available at BRIC-NABI website www.nabi.res.in.
Any corrigendum or amendment to the advertisement will be published only on the institute's website. Before applying, candidates may refer to the BRIC-NABI website and apply accordingly.
(Manager Administration)

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE NO. NIT/11/26/28, Dated: 21/09/2026
On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Materials Manager/ South East Central Railway, Bilaspur Division, invites E-Tender for the following items:

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Due Date	Due Time	Tender Cost (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)
1	11265789	21/10/2026	10:30	0.00	254550.00

Description :- Design, manufacture, supply, installation, testing, commissioning and prove out of Electric Overhead Traveling crane of Capacity 25/5 Ton for Coaching Complex Ambikapur as per attached technical specification (as per specification no. COFMOW/IR/EOTC/2021, Rev-1) . [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]
Tender, please visit IREPS Website at <https://www.ireps.gov.in>
Note: In controversial condition regarding description, English text version will be considered certified.
Sr. Divl. Materials Manager S.E.C. Railway/Bilaspur
CPR/10/421

INDIAN RAILWAYS
PATIALA LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
PATIALA - 147003
Tel.: 2396000, 2396001, Fax No.: 91-0175-2306413
Notice Inviting Electronic Tenders
On behalf of President of India Principal Chief Materials Manager/PLW/Patiala invites tenders in electronic form for following items:
e-Tender Notice No. 26 ET/2026-27

S. N.	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	Tender Closing Date
1	02261136	Labyrinth Sealing Ring Drive End For Yongi Make AC Motor	100 Nos.	30.10.2026
2	02261180	02 Types of Field Coil ASM	47 Nos.	13.10.2026
3	02261164	02 Types of Bull Gear	462 Nos.	02.11.2026

Tender closing Time 15:00 Hrs.
The prospective Tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or <http://www.plw.indianrailways.gov.in>, for detailed description of items & other terms and conditions of tender document. Please note that Tenderers can submit their quotations only through <http://www.ireps.gov.in>.
Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 23 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 20251164A may be read as 15.10.2026. 3356/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PUBLIC NOTICE
(Original Property Document Lost)
I, K. Kaarthikeyan (Voter ID No.: IKU0783233), son of Mr. R. Kirubhakaran, aged 61 years, residing at Door No. 7/7, Navarkulam Main Road, Morattandi, Auroville Post, Pattanur Village, Vanur Taluk, Villupuram District, PIN 605101, do hereby inform to the General Public about the loss of the Original Deed of Sale pertaining to my property, executed by Mrs. Jayammal in favour of Mrs. Gengammal (who is the mother/grandmother of my Vendors), conveying Land measuring One Acre in Ayan Punjai S.No.17/5 situated in Pattanur Village, Vanur Taluk, Villupuram District (now as per Patta S.Nos.76/1A and 76/1B situated at Navarkulam Main Road, Pattanur Village, Vanur Taluk, Villupuram District, PIN 605101) and registered as Document No.739 of 1963 dated 07.05.1963 in the Office of the Sub-Registrar, Vanur, and inspite of my best efforts, the same could not be traced out by me as on date. If anyone finds or possesses the aforesaid original document, please contact me on my Mobile No. 9789986736 or at the following residential address.
K. Kaarthikeyan
Door No. 7/7, Navarkulam Main Road, Morattandi, Auroville Post, Pattanur Village, Vanur Taluk, Villupuram District, PIN 605101.
Date : 26.09.2026
Place: Pattanur

REPAIR/RECONDITIONING OF TRACTION MOTOR AT MALDA TOWN
E-Tender Notice No. TRS-MLDT-07-26-27 Dated: 22-09-2026.
Name of work with its location: For & on behalf of the President of India, Tenders are invited from bonafide contractors for awarding contract of "Repair / Reconditioning of Traction Motor (6FRA-6068) in (03) three phase electric locomotives at DLS/Malda Town". The work shall be completed within twenty four (24) months from receipt of LOA.
Estimate cost of work: ₹ 35,02,240/- . Earnest Money: ₹70,000/- . Last date & time for submission of tender: At 15.00 hrs. on 19-10-2026. The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website www.ireps.gov.in
Sr. DEE/TRS/Malda Town
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

Directorate of Tourism, Government of Jharkhand
2nd Floor, FFP Building, HEC Campus, Dhurwa, Ranchi – 834004
Email: dirjharkhandtourism@gmail.com/jdcldt02@gmail.com

EOI Reference No.: 937/2026 Dated:-24/09/2026
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) NOTICE
Jharkhand Tourism Development Corporation Limited (JTDCL), Government of Jharkhand, invites online applications from eligible and experienced Printing Agencies/Printers for **"Empanelment of Printing Agencies/Printers for a Period of Two (02) Years and Rate Contract for Specified Ticket Items for Jharkhand Tourism Development Corporation Limited (JTDCL)"**. The document can be downloaded from the website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>. The title is exactly in line with the EOI document.
Response to this EOI shall be deemed to have been done after careful study and examination of this document with full understanding of its implications. This section provides general information about the issuer, important dates and addresses and the overall eligibility criteria for the parties.
NIT DETAIL

Particulars	Details
Mode of Tendering	Online through Jharkhand e-Procurement Portal
Tender Portal	https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in/
Tender Document Fee	₹5,900/- including GST @18% (Non-refundable)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	₹10,000/-
EOI Publication Date	26/09/2026 by 11:00 AM
Pre-Submission Meeting	06/10/2026, 03:00 PM Onwards
Last Date for Receiving Queries/Clarifications	03/10/2026 by 03:00 PM
Submission Deadline	13/10/2026 by 05:00 PM
Opening of EOI Responses	Date and Time: 15/10/2026 , 11:00 AM
Period of Empanelment	Two (02) Years
Address for Communications	Jharkhand Tourism Development Corporation Limited, 6th Floor, Premium Suite Building, JUPMI Campus, Plant Plaza Road, Dhurwa, Ranchi – 834004 Website: https://jtdcl.jharkhand.gov.in/ Email: jdcldt02@gmail.com

- JTDCL reserves the right to amend/change the EOI schedule through corrigendum/addendum.
- JTDCL reserves the right to amend, modify, withdraw or cancel the EOI process without assigning any reason.
- Applicants are advised to regularly visit the Jharkhand e-Procurement Portal for corrigenda, addenda, clarifications and other updates.

Deputy Director, Sd/- Directorate of Tourism Government of Jharkhand
PR 390448 Tourism, Art Culture Sports And Youth Affairs (26-27)#D

जिला परिषद का कार्यालय, प० सिंहभूम, चाईबासा ।
(Email – zpchaibasa@gmail.com)
ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- **ZP/CHAIBASA/12/2026-27**
1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :-

युप सं०	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन राशि	परिमाणु विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
01.	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम जिला अन्तर्गत जिला परिषद, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम के कर्मचारी आवासीय परिसर में बहुमंजिला कर्मचारी आवास के निर्माण।	4,86,55,300	9,74,000	10,000	18 MONTHS

- वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – दिनांक– 20.09.2026
- ई-निविदा प्रारंभ की तिथि एवं समय– दिनांक– 20.09.2026 से दिनांक– 11.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।
- ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान– जिला परिषद का कार्यालय, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।
- ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय– दिनांक– 13.10.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे।
- ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता– जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।
- संस्था की सूचना का दूरभाष संख्या – 7209247617 (संबंधित जिला अभियंता का दूरभाष संख्या)
- परिमाणु विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है, तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
- सरकार के संयुक्त सचिव ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग झारखण्ड सरकार राँची के पत्रांक 02(नि०नि-17)-251/23 ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग 3130(नि०), राँची, दिनांक 09.10.2023 द्वारा दिये गये निर्देश के अनुपालन में सभी कामजात के साथ, निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि **Online Mode** द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
- निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुद्रातान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।
- निविदा में सिर्फ जिला परिषद, चाईबासा के अन्तर्गत पंजीकृत समुचित श्रेणी के संवेदक ही भाग ले सकेंगे।
- निविदा डबल बीड प्रद्धति के आधार पर किया जायेगा।
- स्थानीय संवेदकों को प्रथमिकता दी जायेगी। किसी भी समय बिना सूचना के निविदा रद्द एवं किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन करने का अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरी को सुरक्षित रहेगा एवं इस पर किसी प्रकार का दावा या आपत्ति मान्य नहीं होगा।
- विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए जिला का वेब साईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद, प० सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।
PR 390460 (West Singhbhum) 26-27 (D)

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
Filling up the post of Director General,
Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (DG, ICERT)
Applications are invited for filling up the post of Director General, Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (in Level 15 in the Pay Matrix) in accordance with the provisions of the Information Technology Act 2000. The terms and conditions of service of the Director General are regulated as per the Information Technology (Salary, Allowances and Terms & Conditions of Service of the Director General, Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) Rules, 2012, as amended from time to time.
For application format, eligibility conditions, requisite qualifications, pay and allowances, and other details, log on to Ministry's website www.meity.gov.in or CCA's website www.cert-in.org.in.
Application duly prepared in the prescribed proforma should reach Deputy Secretary (Personnel), Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Electronics Niketan, 6 CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003, within 45 days from the date of publication of this advertisement in the Employment News.
CBC 061011/1/0019/2627



Overweight and weak

The UN is unwieldy, and needs to move away from superpower hegemony

The 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) could have been written off as just another year, with another set of speeches delivered on the global multilateral stage. However, this year, the UN’s annual Summit has a unique sense of urgency. This is UN Secretary-General (UNSG) António Guterres’s final session, after a tenure marked by a record number of global crises, conflicts, pandemics, climate disasters and the advent of a dangerous age of Artificial Intelligence. Not since the Second World War have there been so many conflicts; one study recorded more than 65 conflicts across 35 countries in 2025, the highest since 1946. Growing polarisation on every major issue, wars by global superpowers in violation of the UN charter, nuclear threats and the imposition of unilateral and illegitimate sanctions have weakened the UN, which at 81 seems overweight, weak and unrepresentative of the world. This makes it an important year for the world to unite in favour of a strengthened and reformed UN while choosing the next UNSG to guide that process over the next decade. This is an important year for South Asia too, with the election of Bangladesh’s Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman as the President of the UNGA’s 81st session; he will oversee the UNSG’s selection. It was disappointing that the world’s most powerful leaders and those at the heart of the conflicts in Ukraine, Gaza and the Persian Gulf failed to suggest solutions for the future. U.S. President Donald Trump spoke about the possible “annihilation” of Iran, and defended U.S. actions in Venezuela. Much to India’s chagrin, he again claimed to have negotiated peace in conflicts including the 2025 India-Pakistan four-day war. Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian referred to the U.S. and Israel as “murderers, terrorists and assassins”. The Russian President skipped the session, while the U.S. denied visas to the Palestinian delegation. An initiative led by the European Union and a few other countries, co-sponsored by India, to build a Partnership for Multilateralism (P4M) beyond superpower hegemony is well-meaning, but was drowned out by the rancour at this year’s UNGA. For India, this year was significant as the Narendra Modi government launched a campaign for a second two-year non-permanent term in the UN Security Council in 2028-29. It was therefore surprising that Mr. Modi decided to skip the UNGA speech this year, and the multilateral summits on the side-lines, fresh from his hosting of the Delhi BRICS Summit. India’s voice, of a balancing power that speaks for a rules-based international order based on the UN Charter, diplomacy and dialogue, is needed more than ever amidst the global warmongering.

Narrowed posture

Karnataka must not reject the full framework of eco-sensitive areas

The Kasturirangan Report bears a pro-development attitude that allows human occupation and a range of economic activity across the Western Ghats, yet the Karnataka Assembly unanimously repudiated its recommendations. A grievance concerned the accuracy of the remote-sensing and satellite data from 2012 that the Report uses to distinguish natural from human-dominated landscapes. Another concern was its recommendation that an entire revenue village be placed within an ‘ecologically sensitive area’ (ESA) if at least 20% of its area is sensitive. This could bring farmland and human settlements within the ESA even when sensitive areas occupy only a fraction of the village. Following the Centre’s directive to States in 2013-14 to begin ground-truthing the Report’s recommendations, Karnataka faced bipartisan opposition centered on concerns about livelihoods, with vested interests, including stakeholders of activities both the Gadgil and the Kasturirangan Reports restrict/ban such as mining, allegedly fanning fears of displacement. The State thus elected to resist the ESA framework. Although the Assembly’s resolution proposes returning to the unfinished task of producing an alternative map, the government’s posture also faces a wider challenge. The Centre’s interim directions in 2013 preserve some protection for the ecosystems that the State stewards, but for the government and the businesses within potential ESAs, the delay may prolong uncertainty over what forms of planned development will ultimately be permitted. Broadly, particular States confront the economic and political consequences of local resistance and foregone development while the country as a whole will capture much of the national benefit of conserving the Ghats, so States have an incentive to negotiate the ESAs’ extent down. However, as of mid-2026, Gujarat was reportedly close to an agreement with the Centre, Tamil Nadu had no substantive disagreement, Kerala wanted to reduce its already ground-truthed 9,993 sq. km to 8,805 sq. km, and Maharashtra and Goa wanted 378 and 21 villages omitted, respectively. These instances of progress (such as they are), the Ghats’ continuity across six States, and the Centre’s 2024 decision to allow ESAs in the region to be notified State by State increase pressure on Karnataka without legally binding it to its neighbours’ choices. Specifically, Karnataka’s ability to continue rejecting the framework as a whole becomes harder to sustain if it does not also produce an equally considered alternative. Karnataka needs to reconcile the apprehensions of its farmers and workers with the responsibilities accruing to the State with the largest share (by area) of the proposed ESAs.

Urged to ban tobacco, Napoleon III, Emperor of France (1852-70), replied, “This vice brings in one hundred million francs in taxes every year. I will certainly forbid it at once – as soon as you can name a virtue that brings in as much revenue.” His uncle, Napoleon Bonaparte, is also credited with calling vices “very good patriots” (though the attribution is uncertain), while Ralph Waldo Emerson observed that “tobacco could cheerfully carry the load of armies”. Different voices, one hard-headed insight: vices are fiscally invaluable. Yet, every age has moral crusaders whose puritanical zeal to ban tobacco, alcohol, or lotteries rests on the misconception – and conceit – that the state can extinguish persistent demand simply by declaring an activity unlawful. Pragmatists know better: a prohibition may be morally appealing yet administratively futile – or, worse, positively counterproductive. The United States learnt this lesson the hard way. Following a sustained temperance campaign, it imposed prohibition through the Eighteenth Amendment and the Volstead Act, from 1920 to 1933. While suppressing legal supply, prohibition left demand intact, fuelling a lucrative black market controlled by violent syndicates such as Al Capone’s. Bootlegging corrupted public institutions, deprived governments of excise revenue and imposed heavy enforcement costs. The Twenty-First Amendment repealed prohibition, recognising that a regulated and taxed market could cause fewer harms than an unenforceable ban. States in India that have experimented with prohibition have faced similar challenges.

The argument for regulation Lotteries are undoubtedly a vice, though arguably less pernicious than tobacco or alcohol. They disproportionately burden poorer households, encouraging them to stake scarce income on remote chances of reward. Rapid draws and instant games can encourage compulsive play and loss-chasing, while giant jackpots distort risk perception. Credit sales, opaque odds and manipulative advertising compound these harms. These are powerful arguments for stringent regulation, not necessarily prohibition. Lottery bans can push players towards smuggled tickets, *matka*, *satta*, single-digit rackets and offshore portals. Operating through cash agents and mule accounts, these enterprises lack audits and age restrictions, secure prize funds and effective remedies against fraud. Governments lose lottery surpluses and GST revenue, while legitimate vendors, many of them poor or disabled, lose livelihoods and enforcement costs rise. In seeking to protect the vulnerable, the state may instead leave them at the mercy of unaccountable operators.



K. Ashok Vardhan Shetty
Retired IAS officer, a former Vice-Chancellor of the Indian Maritime University, Chennai, and Member, The Justice Kurian Joseph Committee on Union-State Relations

The international norm Lotteries are legal in nearly four-fifths of countries. Blanket prohibition survives mainly in countries enforcing strict Sharia-based gambling prohibitions, such as Saudi Arabia, Iran and Brunei, and in closed ideological regimes such as Cuba. Across diverse political and economic systems, the norm is controlled legality, with lottery surpluses allocated transparently to education, health care, sports, welfare or infrastructure. Nearly 70% of lottery jurisdictions follow the public-operator model, in which a government body, statutory authority or State-owned company runs the lottery while private firms provide retail and technology services. Under the concession model, the State regulates the lottery but grants operating rights to a private concessionaire. Federal countries generally entrust lotteries to their constituent units while permitting voluntary cooperation across borders. Lotteries operate in 45 of the 50 U.S. States and Washington DC; all 10 Canadian provinces and three territories; all six Australian States and both mainland territories; and all 16 German Länder. Authorisation in one jurisdiction does not confer the right to sell in another. Cross-border sales require the destination jurisdiction’s consent or participation in a cooperative arrangement. The U.S.’s Powerball, Canada’s Lotto 6/49, Australian lottery blocs and Germany’s DLTB allow participating jurisdictions to pool players and prizes while retaining regulatory autonomy. A Lok Sabha reply of March 14, 2023, identified only nine States operating lotteries: Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Keralam, Maharashtra, Mizoram, Nagaland, Punjab, Sikkim and West Bengal. Amid persistent State fiscal stress, the widespread preference for prohibition deserves reconsideration. Government-organised lotteries fall under Entry 40 of the Union List. The Lotteries (Regulation) Act, 1998, permits States to organise lotteries subject to Section 4 conditions, Regulation, not prohibition, can curb lottery harms while preserving accountability

Revisiting India’s nuclear doctrine without revising it

India’s nuclear doctrine has remained largely unchanged for over two decades, even as its security environment has shifted dramatically. Since its operationalisation in 2003, China’s military rise has accelerated, Pakistan’s nuclear posture has evolved, disruptive technologies have reshaped deterrence, and geopolitical competition has become more multipolar. Yet, the doctrine’s core principles – credible minimum deterrence and a declared No First Use (NFU) posture – have endured, albeit with a specific provision retaining the option of nuclear retaliation following a major biological or chemical attack on India or Indian forces. The question is whether a framework crafted for the early 2000s remains fully aligned with the security challenges of the mid-2020s. **A doctrine for another era, strategic shifts** India’s nuclear doctrine emerged from the distinct strategic context of the late 1990s. The 1998 Pokhran-II tests established India as a nuclear weapons state, while Kargil (1999) showed that nuclear deterrence did not rule out conventional war. The 1999 Draft Nuclear Doctrine and the Cabinet Committee on Security’s January 4, 2003 decision sought to reconcile deterrence with restraint. The 2003 decision operationalised a posture based on credible minimum deterrence, No First Use (NFU) and massive retaliation to a nuclear attack, supported by a survivable second-strike capability and firm civilian control. Judged by its original objectives, the doctrine has provided continuity, predictability and strategic stability for more than two decades. The question is whether the assumptions underpinning it remain stable. The strategic environment underpinning the framework has changed in three important ways. First, China and Pakistan have grown more strategically aligned. When the doctrine was



Advitya Madan
Analyst on geopolitics, international and defence affairs, commanded 15 Punjab in Lebanon under the United Nations Flag, commanded 27 Sector as DIG in Churachandpur, Manipur, and was Brigadier Operational Logistics in HQ Western Command

India’s nuclear doctrine faces new strategic, technological and geopolitical challenges

formulated, the two nuclear-armed neighbours posed distinct challenges; today, those challenges are increasingly interconnected. China has expanded and modernised its nuclear forces, strengthened military infrastructure along the Line of Actual Control and deepened defence cooperation with Pakistan. Pakistan has diversified its nuclear capabilities, including tactical nuclear weapons intended to offset India’s conventional advantage. India must therefore account for the possibility that pressures from two closely aligned nuclear adversaries could interact during a crisis. The second shift is technological. Artificial intelligence, cyber capabilities, space-based surveillance, hypersonic weapons and ballistic missile defence are reshaping deterrence by shortening decision-making timelines, increasing the vulnerability of command-and-control networks and complicating assumptions about assured retaliation. These technologies do not invalidate the doctrine’s core principles, but they alter the environment in which they must operate. Nuclear deterrence ultimately depends on the alignment of doctrine, capability and survivability. The third shift is geopolitical. The Indo-Pacific has become a key arena of great-power competition, while the international system has grown more multipolar. U.S.-China rivalry, closer China-Russia coordination and India’s expanding partnerships have reshaped the security environment. Nuclear doctrine can no longer be viewed solely through bilateral deterrence; regional crises are increasingly shaped by wider geopolitical competition. **Review, not revision** Strategic doctrines are policy instruments, not immutable documents. In India’s case, a review could examine emerging technologies, command-and-control resilience, second-strike

capabilities and the continuing relevance of existing concepts, including the doctrine’s approach to retaliation. The issue of massive retaliation deserves scrutiny. Pakistan’s tactical nuclear weapons were intended to complicate India’s response options below the level of strategic exchange. A review could assess whether India’s declaratory posture provides sufficient deterrent clarity across nuclear contingencies, without necessarily changing its core principles. There are, however, reasons for caution. India’s doctrine has reinforced its image as a restrained and responsible nuclear power while providing continuity in deterrence. Ambiguity over established principles, particularly NFU, could create uncertainty, encourage adversaries to recalibrate and complicate crisis management. The priority, therefore, should be to strengthen operational capabilities, modernise delivery systems and improve command-and-control resilience rather than reopen declaratory policy. A review of NFU need not mean abandoning it. It could reaffirm its rationale, clarify its scope and ensure that supporting capabilities remain credible. Reviewing a doctrine is not the same as revising it. **Building credible capabilities** For India, any doctrinal review should also assess survivability, command and control, intelligence, early warning, cyber resilience and the nuclear triad. The aim should be to ensure that India’s declared policy remains backed by credible capabilities in a changing strategic environment, while aligning nuclear policy with its broader diplomatic objectives and strategic autonomy. Ultimately, a nuclear doctrine is an instrument of statecraft, not an immutable policy. India’s commitment to restraint, credible deterrence and responsible nuclear stewardship remains an enduring strategic asset.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Sanctity of public office The desire to cling to office indefinitely, while disregarding transparency, accountability, the Constitution and the law, appears to have become the new norm in India. The values of humility, transparency and accountability in public life seem to have become things of the past, especially under the

government of the day. Its top leader may have many achievements to his name, but he has also encouraged an office-centric political culture within the BJP and among those joining it from other parties. The priority appears to be retaining office rather than upholding the sanctity of constitutional democracy. Leader of the Opposition (Lok Sabha) Rahul Gandhi

has urged Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar to resign (Page 1, September 25). Why should Mr. Kumar, when he has the backing of those at the top? The Election Commission of India’s constitutional responsibility is to ensure free and fair elections, and its decisions must command public confidence. The question is: why should constitutional

institutions not function in the letter and spirit of the Constitution and the law? Holding a constitutional office means little if its occupant does not uphold the values and the responsibilities attached to it. **P.K. Sharma,** Barnala, Punjab **Resignation demand** If the Chief Election

Commissioner of India quits, will all the deleted names be included in the Special Intensive Revision list? Conducting elections in a country such as India is a huge task because of its large population. In the last round of elections held in some States, the process was appreciated by many developed countries, whose representatives had said that the elections were

conducted in a free and fair manner. All appreciation goes to the Election Commission of India. Demanding the resignation of hardworking people with clean hands will only affect the country. **K.V. Sundaravelu,** Bengaluru Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the full postal address and the full name.

GROUND ZERO



Rajthal residents in Hansi, Haryana, keep round-the-clock vigil at the village entrance to prevent entry of drug peddlers. SHIV KUMAR PUSHKAR

The villages fighting back against drugs

The drug menace has spread from the borders of Haryana to the State's agricultural and semi-urban heartland, forcing khaps, gram panchayats, and community groups to step in where police action alone has failed to contain it. Communities are resorting to night patrols, fines, and direct action against peddlers.

Ashok Kumar reports on these efforts and the widening gap in de-addiction and rehabilitation facilities

On the side of a busy road cutting through Rajthal village in Haryana's Hansi district, around 150 kilometres north-west of Delhi, stands a bright red-and-white banner tied to a yellow police barricade. In bold letters in Hindi, it reads, "*Nasha ke khilaf gram panchayat Rajthal ka sakht sandesh* (The strict message from the Rajthal gram panchayat (village council) against drug/substance abuse)." The warning below says: sell drugs in the village and pay ₹1 lakh; help a drug peddler get bail and pay another ₹1 lakh.

A few steps behind the barricade, men wearing white kurtas and turbans sit on red plastic chairs in a circle in the shade of a roadside tree. They are Rajthal's round-the-clock *thekri pehra* (community-led vigil). Their job is to guard their village and the entire stretch against drugs.

Satyawan Singh, 65, says, "We have taken it upon ourselves to not just rid our area but also the entire State of drugs. The Satrol khap, Nau-gama khap, and Bara khap (the names of various khaps active in Hisar and Hansi) have extended support to us, which has given our campaign new strength. Since then, we have become even more active and have started reaching out to every village grappling with the drug problem."

According to the police and locals, the drug crisis first took hold in Haryana's districts bordering Punjab and Rajasthan – Sirsa, Fatehabad, Jind, Kurukshetra, Kaithal, and Ambala – as heroin, locally known as *chitta*; poppy husk; and pharmaceutical drugs made their way across porous State borders. From these entry points, local dealers and small-time peddlers gradually built their own networks, carrying the trade deeper into the State's agricultural and semi-urban heartland, into districts such as Hisar, Hansi, Rohtak, Sonapat, and Panipat.

The trade has grown exponentially over the years. As per the Magnitude of Substance Use in India-2019 report, commissioned by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment and conducted in collaboration with the National Drug Dependence Treatment Centre, All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi, 5.9 lakh people in Haryana need help for opioid-related problems. This is the third-highest number among States, after Uttar Pradesh (10.7 lakh) and Punjab (7.2 lakh).

Haryana is also among the States with the highest proportion of its population affected by opioid use, along with Punjab, Delhi, and several northeastern States – Mizoram, Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, and Manipur. The report estimates that 1.2 lakh people in Haryana need help for sedative use, putting it among the six States with the highest usage. Another 55,000 people in the State inject drugs, the sixth highest in the country.

As addiction has spread and concerns have grown over the efficacy of police action, villages have begun looking beyond the State machinery for ways to contain the problem. Khaps, social organisations, and gram sabhas have formed

We had reached a point where drug users and sellers had turned the village into a marketplace. People would enter homes and stand in queues to buy smack, *chitta*, ganja and other drugs.

ANIL GODARA
Brother-in-law of the Sarpanch in Rajthal village

committees to monitor suspected drug peddlers and even impose their own deterrents.

Keeping vigil

Residents say the drug problem in Rajthal, on the Jind-Hansi link road, has been around for nearly a decade, but it has worsened sharply over the past three years. They allege that the number of houses involved in selling drugs has increased from two or three to 25 or 26.

With the spread of drugs has come a rise in thefts, particularly from agricultural fields, say residents. They allege that to finance drug consumption, copper wires from submersible pumps, motorcycles, utensils, and other articles are stolen and sold as scrap.

"We had reached a point where drug users and sellers had turned the village into a marketplace," says Anil Godara, 38, the brother-in-law of Sarpanch Renu Devi. "People would enter homes and stand in queues to buy smack, *chitta*, ganja and other drugs."

According to Poonam Devi, 38, a yoga teacher working in the Haryana Kaushal Rozgar Nigam, a government department, the spread of drug use in Rajthal has changed the way women move through public spaces. "Those who use drugs stare in an improper manner at women. Sometimes they try to stop women riding scooters when they are returning from work," she says.

Devi says the bus stand has, in particular, become a place of concern. Women who park their scooters or motorcycles there are often warned by shopkeepers that their vehicles could be stolen by drug users. She says a bicycle and a motorcycle have been stolen from the area.

For girls and women going to school or college, the fear extends beyond theft. "We do not even feel safe wearing bangles or chains," she says. Women who once moved around the village freely in the mornings and evenings now often go out accompanied by men, she adds.



The poster in Rajthal warns that selling drugs in the village will attract a fine of ₹1 lakh; helping a drug peddler get bail will attract a fine of another ₹1 lakh. SHIV KUMAR PUSHKAR

Alarmed by the spread and addiction to drugs, locally known as *sukha nasha* (dry intoxicant), as well as the spurt in thefts, the residents of Rajthal approached the district administration and the police to seek their support in launching their initiative. They also held a gram sabha meeting, where residents across age groups agreed to participate in the campaign. The village then formed the *thekri pehra* at two points to keep a watch on people and vehicles entering and leaving Rajthal.

The *thekri pehra*, launched on August 26, involves groups of young men keeping watch, with 15-20 people stationed at each point after 9 p.m. During the day, the number of villagers, including the elderly, can rise to 50-60 or more. Village youth also ride motorcycles to chase people suspected of entering the village to buy drugs.

This practice has a history. The Punjab Village and Small Towns Patrol Act, 1918, outlines "the performance of nightly patrol duty by the inhabitants of villages...in case of emergency."

Residents say they have caught more than 400 people so far, including students, farmers, youth from well-off families, and a few girls aged 17-18. In several cases, parents have learned about their children's drug use only after the villagers informed them, say residents.

Ankur Bisla, 30, who is part of the *thekri pehra* team, says most of those caught consuming drugs are from Haryana, including neighbouring villages and areas around Panipat, Sirsa, and Sonapat. "Some of them had travelled from Gurugram as well," he says.

However, the job is not easy. After the vigil restricted the movement of outsiders into the village, drug sellers have become cleverer by taking supplies outside the village. Residents say they have noticed vehicles leaving the village in the wee hours, between 1 a.m. and 4 a.m.

Hansi Superintendent of Police Vinod Kumar says community participation has become an important part of the police campaign against drugs. In response to the villagers' demands for greater police presence, the police deployed four personnel, including a woman constable, along with a police control room vehicle and a checkpoint, a month after the campaign was launched.

On September 23, around 150 police personnel and a canine squad conducted a three-hour house-to-house search operation in the village. "But such operations can be challenging as people often get alerted by police activity and move or conceal contraband," he says.

When the people take over

Independent journalist Vijender Kumar, who runs a YouTube Channel called NewsMike24, says there is a history of illicit liquor trade in some of these villages. He says what was once largely confined to liquor has evolved into a more dangerous drug market, increasingly involving women too, and affecting the youth from poor families. The survey highlights the vulnerability of children: Haryana has 35,000 children who need help for inhalant use, the fourth-highest number among the five States with the highest figures.

The emergence of heroin is particularly worrying, says Kumar. He points out that 5.7 kg of heroin was seized in Jind alone a month ago, valued at around ₹11 crore in the international market.

Kumar says the fight against drugs in Haryana's villages is increasingly being led by residents. He recalls how Ashrafgarh-Dauri village in Jind, close to the Punjab border, confronted the problem about two years ago. "Villagers formed a 20-25-member team comprising the youth, government employees, retired people, and ex-servicemen to maintain round-the-clock vigil. They installed 25-26 CCTV cameras outside the houses of alleged drug sellers and imposed fines. The number of people coming into the village to buy drugs reduced," he says.

Lochab village, once a drug hotspot, also brought drug activity under control after the panchayat imposed fines and took strict action. "But



The police focus on curtailing the commercial supply of drugs, but the combination of the dark web, cryptocurrency, and courier services has changed the way drugs are trafficked.

RAJENDAR KUMAR MEENA
Deputy Inspector General of Police,
Haryana State Narcotics Control Bureau

new hotspots have emerged in Rajthal, Petwar, and Sulchani, where drug supply remains high," says Kumar.

Rajthal resident Ratan Sharma says the police are reluctant to conduct searches in cases involving small quantities of drugs. "They say they cannot register a case over one or two packets. But if searches are not conducted, how will larger quantities be recovered," he asks.

Sagar Preet Hooda, Director General of Police (DGP), Chandigarh, and a native of Haryana's Rohtak, has conceptualised a village-based programme that brings local residents together to tackle the growing drug problem as a community-led social intervention. Called the Panchgama development model, the programme will be launched in Jind on October 11. In its first phase, it will cover nearly 300 villages, grouped into 60 clusters of five villages each.

"Through the Jind social forum, volunteers with roots in Haryana will share their experiences, expertise, and networks to support rural youth. They will work alongside existing community and government institutions," he says.

Several khaps, too, have announced that they will impose fines on those indulging in drug-peddling in view of the growing problem.

Even as communities are taking matters into their own hands, Bisla questions the lack of political will in dealing with the growing menace. "On the one hand, the BJP has launched the Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra (an anti-drug political campaign) in neighbouring Punjab. On the other, it has done precious little to contain the menace in the State that it has governed for the past 12 years," he says.

State measures and hurdles

As part of its efforts to combat the drug menace, the State government constituted the Haryana State Narcotics Control Bureau (HSNCB) on August 25, 2020. So far, 2,353 FIRs involving commercial quantities of narcotics have been registered under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985, and 6,256 accused people have been arrested, according to a press conference held in June this year by Additional Director General of Police, HSNCB.

In a parallel crackdown on drug-derived wealth, assets worth ₹72.70 crore have been seized, frozen, or attached to date. As part of the campaign against habitual and organised traffickers, preventive detention orders were issued against 156 accused under the Prevention of Illicit Traffic in Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1988. In addition, property attachment proceedings were initiated against 432 individuals to target illegally acquired assets generated by the drug trade.

Rajendar Kumar Meena, Deputy Inspector General of Police, HSNCB, says that going by drug seizures, heroin is the most prevalent in the districts bordering Delhi – Gurugram, Faridabad, Jhajjar – followed by cocaine, MDMA (a synthetic psychoactive drug), ganja, and poppy straw. "The police have a three-pronged strategy to combat the drug menace – enforcement, awareness, and de-addiction," says Meena, conceding that supply cannot be totally curtailed till the time that there is demand.

"The police focus on curtailing the commercial supply of drugs, but the combination of the dark web, cryptocurrency, and courier services has changed the way drugs are trafficked."

The gaps in rehabilitation

Vipin Sharma, the founder of Ankush Foundation, a drug rehabilitation centre in Hisar, says Haryana's response to addiction remains focused on de-addiction and regulatory compliance and gives little attention to long-term rehabilitation.

After more than two decades in the field, Sharma, a recovering addict himself, says the biggest problem is that policies are often framed without consulting those delivering services, such as rehabilitation and de-addiction programmes, on ground.

Sharma argues that frequent inspections and increasingly prescriptive rules have made it harder for rehabilitation centres to function effectively. "Rules requiring clinical psychologists at every centre don't take into account the limited availability of trained professionals. There is also excessive focus on specifications, such as the distance between beds. These requirements divert attention from the central problem of treating addiction," he says.

For Sharma, the largest gap is the absence of sustained rehabilitation after medical treatment. "De-addiction is a medical treatment. It can address physical dependence on a substance, but it is not the complete solution," he says. "Without long-term rehabilitation, a patient's psychological dependence is not addressed."

Sharma says Haryana lacks a rehabilitation centre run or supported entirely by the State government (there are eight centres in the State supported by the Union government). Private centres operate without government assistance, but face regulatory and licensing hurdles.

An inmate at the rehabilitation centre says, "For an addict, quitting drugs is only the beginning. The real battle is staying away from them – a struggle that can last a lifetime." Recovery, he says, cannot end at the centre's gates; it requires the continued support of family and society to help those battling addiction rebuild their lives and find their way back into the mainstream.

Govt. yet to decide how open-field caste data will be sorted, tabulated

Opposition, OBC groups are against open-column option in 2027 Census; they say 2011 Socio-Economic Caste Census also had an open field to record caste, yielding over 46 lakh caste names; successive governments did not act on it, they add

Abhinav Lakshman
NEW DELHI

More than a month after the Union government notified the questionnaire for the second phase of the 2027 Census, finalising an open-column method to record caste, officials told *The Hindu* that a decision is yet to be taken on how the government will sort, tabulate, and rationalise the data collected through this method.

Under this method, people who are not from the Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes can enter their caste names in an open column. This is unlike other modes of enumerating castes wherein people have to choose from a list of castes, a method used by the Bihar and Telangana governments in their caste surveys. The open-field method allows people to opt for a “no-caste” option; they can al-



The questions in the second phase include those on caste and fields for family particulars and COVID vaccinations. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

so choose not to disclose their caste name.

Experts, Opposition parties, and associations representing Other Backward Classes have criticised the decision to use the open-column method, arguing that it is bound to repeat the results of the 2011 Socio-Economic Caste Census exercise, which yielded over 46 lakh different caste names. Successive governments had shelved that report, they

say. A senior government official said that discussions on how to make sense of the caste data returned through the 2027 Census forms have not yet been initiated, adding that this will happen as the fieldwork on the exercise progresses over the coming months.

Apart from the caste question, which has been introduced in India's census forms for the first time since Independence, the

method of sorting and tabulating the data for the other new questions is also in various stages of discussion within the Office of the Census Commissioner.

13 new questions

The second phase of the 2027 Census exercise lists a total of 40 questions, of which 13 are new questions or data fields that were not part of the previous 2011 census. These include the question on caste and fields for family particulars, ID proofs, and COVID vaccinations.

The government official added that once a holistic proposal is prepared by the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India on the method for sorting the data, this file is sent up the chain to the Union Home Secretary, following which the government will take a final decision, either at the level of the Ministry or the Union Cabinet.

Officials said that each division of the Census office would have to handle the tabulation process for the questions that they are responsible for, after which the file on this methodology is forwarded to the top bureaucrat in the Union Home Ministry.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Professor G.N. Devy, scholar, linguist, and cultural activist, said the Office of the Census Commissioner should have ideally included experts in the discussions on finalising the questions, adding that doubts about the method of post-data collection analysis would have also been addressed at this stage, had the government taken this approach.

The second phase of the Census has already begun in several hilly and remote regions, such as Ladakh and the snow-bound areas of Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Jammu and Kashmir.

J&K CM brings Statehood resolution in Assembly amid loud protests by BJP

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Friday moved a resolution on the restoration of Statehood “in continuation of the 2000 autonomy resolution” and evoked protests from the Opposition BJP legislators, who tore the resolution, climbed the tables and opposed any move to discuss autonomy or Article 370 in the Assembly.

“In addition to the Resolutions passed by this House on 26th June 2000 and 6th November 2024, this House calls upon the Government of India for the immediate and urgent restoration of full Statehood to Jammu and Kashmir and resolves that this Resolution be forwarded to Government of India,” reads the resolution moved by Mr. Abdullah in the Supplementary List of Business.

The Chief Minister said this resolution will “neither replace or subsume previous resolutions of the Assembly” like in 2000 and 2024 on autonomy and special status, respectively.

‘Not unconstitutional’

“We own those resolutions. This resolution is in addition to those resolutions. No one should misconstrue that we are just demanding Statehood and forget about the past resolutions. This is not an unconstitutional resolution,” said Mr. Abdullah.

He said the resolution was purely based on logic. “Not a single anti-national word in it. We have not brought any fresh resolution on autonomy as that already stands passed and is the property of the House,” said Mr. Abdullah.



House uproar: BJP members stage a protest in the J&K Legislative Assembly on Friday. IMRAN NISSAR

He said the fresh resolution was necessitated because the resolution of the Cabinet was not considered the voice of the people. “A resolution from the legislature reflects the will of the entire political spectrum of J&K. Statehood is not about any government, my family or an individual. It is about the entire J&K,” said Mr. Abdullah.

He said this resolution is “merely for the Centre to restore Statehood of J&K”. “Unfortunately, the BJP legislators do not want it. The BJP legislators should have allowed the Speaker to initiate a debate. They could have taken a stand in their speeches. But they don’t want to vote for Statehood and all 29 BJP legislators stand as a hurdle to Statehood. The BJP MLAs should neither abstain, nor walk out but vote for or against the resolution,” said Mr. Abdullah.

Parties lend support

Besides the ruling ally Congress and CPI(M), the legislators of the Peoples Democratic Party (PDP), Awami Ittehad Party (AIP) and J&K Peoples Conference (JKPC), also extended their support for the resolution.

“J&K’s accession to India rests on 1947 promises. Statehood is not a matter

of charity,” said JKPC chief and legislator Sajad Lone. PDP legislator Aga Syed Muntazir Mehdi also flashed a placard in favour of Article 370 in the House.

Noisy scenes

Meanwhile, the mention of the 2000 autonomy resolution, which had called for a greater autonomy of the region and was later rejected by Parliament, sparked an uproar from BJP MLAs. They tore the NC resolution, stormed into the Well of the House and climbed onto tables, forcing the Speaker to adjourn the session for half-an-hour. However, noisy scenes continued when the Assembly resumed again. “We are ready to discuss Statehood but this resolution is controversial and disputed. The BJP had rejected the autonomy resolution. Congress should clear its position, from Rahul Gandhi to the State Chief of Congress. Is it with this resolution? Is it with the pre-1953 resolution? Is it with the resolution of [Article] 370, or is it with the government?” said BJP legislator and Leader of Opposition Sunil Sharma.

“So-called autonomy, so-called resolution of 370” will not be allowed to be admitted here, he added.

Trinamool leader Ajit Maity held in extortion case

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The West Bengal Police on Friday arrested Mamata All India Trinamool Congress leader Ajit Maity on charges of extortion. Mr. Maity was arrested from the Pingla police station on charges of taking money from a person named Gautam Das. According to the allegation made by Mr. Das, Mr. Maity had promised him a post in the party in return for the money.

Mr. Maity was arrested from his residence in Kharagpur and taken to the Debra police station.

Mr. Maity won the Pingla constituency in the 2021 Assembly election. However, in 2026, he contested from the same constituency and lost to the BJP candidate. He is currently the Vice-President of the Midnapore Zilla Parishad.

Calcutta HC overturns relief to Congress Nandigram bypoll candidate in 2007 case

Press Trust of India
KOLKATA

A Division Bench of the Calcutta High Court on Friday set aside a Single-Judge Bench order granting relief to the Congress’s Nandigram byelection candidate, Milan Pradhan, from coercive action in a 2007 criminal case.

The Division Bench, presided over by Chief Justice Ravindra Vithalrao Ghuge, held that there was no provision in criminal

law for such interim protection to an accused. It said an accused has the liberty to seek bail after arrest and, if apprehending arrest, can apply for anticipatory bail.

The Bench set aside Thursday’s order directing the police not to take any steps against Mr. Pradhan in the case till October 12.

The Bench observed that the law is the same for everyone and there cannot be a different consideration for a person contest-

ing an election. With the single-Bench order set aside, Mr. Pradhan’s judicial remand till October 7, granted by the Contai ACJM Court, will remain effective. On Thursday, Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya directed the police not to take any steps against Mr. Pradhan till October 12 in connection with the 2007 case at the Khejuri police station in Purba Medinipur district.

Mr. Pradhan was arrested by the Purba Medinipur

district police on September 18 and was shown arrested in connection with the case. The Contai court on Wednesday remanded him in judicial custody till October 7.

Mr. Pradhan faces charges, including of murder and attempt to murder, in the 2007 case linked to the anti-land acquisition movement in Nandigram.

The byelection is scheduled for October 6, with campaigning ending on October 4.

Shaunak sails for Australia with QUAD officers onboard

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Indian Coast Guard (ICG) ship *Shaunak* sailed from Chennai on Friday for Perth as part of the QUAD-at-Sea Ship Observer Mis-

sion, aimed at enhancing maritime interoperability and professional exchanges among India, Australia, Japan and the U.S. The team on board comprises two officers each from India and Japan and one officer each from Australia and the U.S.

राजस्थान सरकार
कार्यालय-निदेशक, पुरातत्व एवं संग्रहालय विभाग, राजस्थान, जयपुर।
अलखंडल परिसर, रामनिवास बाग, जयपुर
सूचना सं. 0141-2820380 (मेल- dirarchraj@gmail.com)
क्रमांक : पुसो/0/2026/21186 दिनांक : 22.09.2026

:- ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या-11/2026-27 :-

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से इस विभाग के अधीन निम्नलिखित यू.पी.एन. नामक के कार्य हेतु राज्य सरकार/राजकीय उपक्रमों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/केन्द्र सरकार/भारतीय पुरातत्व सर्वेक्षण आदि में सम्बन्धित कार्य हेतु निम्नानुसार सूचना श्रेणी में पंजीकृत सर्वेक्षकों/कर्मों से ई-मोली प्रक्रिया से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट www.dior.raajasthan.gov.in, <http://sppp.raajasthan.gov.in> व विभागीय वेबसाइट <http://museumrajasthan.gov.in> पर देखी व काउनलोड की सकती है-

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AMD2627A0048	AMD2627WSOB00074

(आरक्षीय मूनी)
अधिसूचना अधिनियम

DIPR/C/16328/2026

**OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER
WATER RESOURCES ZONE, BHARATPUR**
sinchai Workshop, Near Collectrate office Bharatpur,
E-mail- wrzonebpr@gmail.com

No. Accts/2026-27/2335 Date : 22/09/2026

e-NIB No.- 08/2026-27

On behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan, bids are invited from eligible bidders for the work of -"Construction of Lift (drainage) scheme from Naval Kund & Apsara Kund Punchari to Goverdhan Drain and Renovation & Beautification of Radha Prem & Rasik Ananya Sarovar Jateri Dham Distt Deeg." (Estimated value of work is Rs. 671.90 Lac) Last date of submission of Bid is 13/10/2026. Detailed Bid & Bid document can be seen on & downloaded from official website (<http://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in>, & <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>)

NIB Code No.: WRD2627A0325
UBN No.:- WRD2627WLOB00683

**Additional Chief Engineer
WRD, Zone Bharatpur**

DIPR/C/16328/2026

STATE INFRASTRUCTURE & INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
Regional Office, SIIDCUL, Selaqui, Dehradun. Web site : www.siidcul.com

NIT-03/SIIDCUL/Selaqui/2026 Dated 25.09.2026

Short Term Tender Notice

SIIDCUL invites online bids for "Repair and Maintenance of Existing Kerb stone and Road Resurfacing work at Pharmacy, Selaqui, Dehradun." The tender document would be available from 26.09.2026 till submission date i.e. 17.10.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs. Tender document can be downloaded from <http://www.uktenders.gov.in> or www.siidcul.com. Corrigendum (if any) will be uploaded on the above websites only.

Regional Manager

कार्यालय अधिसूचना अधिनियम, सा.नि.वि.जिला खण्ड प्रथम, उदयपुर
पौडखण्डा केन्द्र प्रथम तल गुप्त बाग रोड, गिरा पीर हारन उदयपुर- 313001
E-Mail:- xendduidapir.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in
Email:- eed1dowidudapir@gmail.com संपर्क नंर 0294-2428933

NO -920 Date:- 17.09.2026

NIT No. 07/2026-2027

Notice Inviting Bid

Bids for "Various Road's & Building Construction, Renewal, Strengthening Works in various schemes in District Udaipur (Raj.) are invited from interested bidders upto 6.00 PM, dated 08.10.2026

Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://ercp.raajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the Rajasthan and <http://pwd.raajasthan.gov.in> website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 368.72 Lacs.

NIB :- PWD2627A2804
1-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12488 2-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12491
3-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12487 4-UBN No :- PWD2627WSOB12503

Your's faithfully
(B.S. Meena)
Executive Engineer
Public Works Department
Distt Dn I Udaipur

DIPR/C/16391/2026

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600, 2945646)
E-mail : edrgs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No.KMSCL/ED/6/2026 Date : 26.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited for the **Procurement of Drugs for Rare Diseases** for Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt of Kerala for the year 2026-27.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. of Items
1.	KMSCL/ED/RD-SAT-2/RC/2026/022 dtd. 26.09.2026	6

Schedule of dates

	Date	Time
Last date of online uploading of tenders	12.10.2026	05.00pm.
Date of technical bid opening	14.10.2026	11.00 am.

Tender document shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.

(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

**GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT**
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
HE-SCH-PLAN-0037-2026/51755 /HE.. Bhubaneswar, Dated : 24.09.2026

Corrigendum-I

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR MAHARAJA SRIRAM CHANDRA BHANJA DEO UNIVERSITY, MAYURBHANJ UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BALASHWAR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.

RFP No. PM-USHA:04/2026 Date: 05.09.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl. No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Now Modified Provisions
1		4	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 28/09/2026 (till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 12/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		4	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 30/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 14/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA / PM-USHA
11001/338/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0062

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Kerala)
THYCAUD PO., THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 695014
Telephone No. 0471-2945600, 2945600
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, e-mail : openders.kmscl@kerala.gov.in
CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No. KMSCL/EP/215/2026 Dated : 25.09.2026

e-TENDER NOTICE (Running Contract)

Online bids are invited for the supply and installation of the following equipment for various Government healthcare institutions across Kerala

Sl. No	Tender No.	Description	Online Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of Online submission
1.	T598/2026	Robotic Surgical System	05.10.2026 11.00 am.	17.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
2.	T599/2026	MRI Compatible Anesthesia work station, MR Compatible Multiparameter Monitor, Cardiac 3D Mapping system, CT Scanner 256 Slice, Pituitary & Vascular doppler.	08.10.2026 11.00 am.	22.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
3.	T600/2026	Cardiac Cath lab with EP Facility Model A, Cardiac Cath lab with EP Facility Model B, Clinical flow cytometer, Bipolar Cautery with sheath for Laparoscopy.	09.10.2026 11.00 am.	22.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
4.	T601/2026	Medical Gas Pipe Line System Model A, Medical Gas Pipe Line System Model B, Intra Vascular Ultrasound (IVUS) Machine and Fractional Flow Reserve machine (FFR) Capability, Operating Microscope with adjustable Arms for Plastic Surgery.	13.10.2026 11.00 am.	24.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
5.	T602/2026	Multiparameter Monitor with Capnogram and IPM, Multiparameter Monitor with Anesthesia gas Monitor, Multifunctional Couch with IV Fluid Stand, Dialysis Consumables, Patient warmer, Suction low pressure, Ventilator CPAP (Noninvasive)	N.A.	09.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
6.	T603/2026	Sequential Compression Devices Calf Pump, Stretcher trolley higher End with CPR Facility, Ultrasonic cleaner, Pharmacy Refrigerator 1000 litre, Modular cold chamber Model B, Micro Centrifuge, Walk in cold Room, Bicarbonate mixer, RO Plant 1000 LPH, RO Plant 3000 LPH, Yag Laser for Glaucoma Clinic, Power Laundry machine, Iron Cot, Noninvasive BIPAP Ventilator, Suction Apparatus	N.A.	12.10.2026 5.00 p.m.
7.	T604 (Ry) 2026	MRI Scanner 1.5 Tesla Normal Bore (Helium Free), Linear Accelerator (LINAC) Ring Gantry, Advanced Phaco Emulsification System, Isoelectric Focusing for Newborn Screening Hematology Analyzer 5 Part Model B, High Speed Centrifuge, Digital Vortex Mixer, Anaerobic Chamber Glove Box, Refrigerated Centrifuge, Dental Laser, Transvaginal Uterine Artery Clamp, Automated CPR System Model B, Schiotz Tonometer, Orbital Atherectomy System, Intra Oral Digital Radiographic System Type B, Micromanipulator System with accessories, Therapeutic Apheresis Machine, HD Laparoscopic System, HD Laparoscopic Instruments, Ergometer, Active Passive Exercise System for Upper and Lower Extremity, Sperm Fuge, Microdebrider for ENT, Body Box for Plethysmography, Tissue Homogenizer, Retractor Set, Diathermy Surgical, Electric Hot air Oven (Dental), Vortex Mixture, 2.5 mm Arthroscope with Trocar and Cannula, PCR Reagents and Kits	N.A.	09.10.2026 5.00 p.m. 17.10.2026 5.00 p.m.

Tender documents and all other information related to tender and bidding process can be downloaded from the website www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.
(Sd/-) Managing Director (Tender Inviting Authority)

A CH-CHE

INBRIEF



‘No commitment made to unions on 5-day work week’

Rejecting claims of bank employee unions regarding a commitment to implement a five-day work week, government sources said there was no commitment on the issue from the Finance Ministry. Bank employee unions under the United Forum of Bank Unions have announced a three-day strike from September 28 to press for their demands, including a five-day work week. The strike, if it materialises, would coincide with the banking sector's half-yearly close. PTI

India should allow exchanges to list on own platform: NSE

India's markets regulator should reconsider allowing exchanges to list on their own platforms, NSE Chairman Srinivas Injeti said on Friday, a day after the bourse operator debuted on rival BSE at a valuation of about \$47 billion. SEBI debated allowing self-listing in 2015 but rejected the idea over potential conflicts of interest, requiring their shares to trade on rival bourses. However, self-listing is permitted in several major global markets. REUTERS

TRAI launches digital rating platform for properties

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) on Friday launched an integrated Digital Connectivity Rating (DCR) platform and a dedicated mobile app to assess and certify in-building mobile and internet connectivity across residential, commercial, and government properties. The platform is designed to enable prospective buyers and tenants to evaluate digital readiness prior to purchasing or leasing. PTI

Coffee Board brews sustainability push with new framework

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

The Coffee Board has developed sustainability standards and is in the process of implementing the certification process, said Kurma Rao, its Chief Executive Officer and Secretary.

India, the world's seventh-largest coffee producer and fifth-largest exporter, exported coffee worth more than \$2 billion in 2025-26, with nearly 39% comprising value-added products., he said.

Indian coffee's distinctive advantage lies in its traditional shade-grown cultivation, which the Board

aims to leverage through the new sustainability standards.

“We have published the standards. We are in the process of implementing the certification and a steering committee has been formed for it,” he told *The Hindu*.

The certification will be done at three levels - first will be done by the Board based on self certification by the growers. The second level will involve independent third-party verification, while the third level will benchmark Indian standards against internationally recognised sustainability frameworks.

AI-led phone price hikes persist, hitting Indian customers

A series of price hikes has put budget phones out of reach for many who choose to wait for festival discounts or settle for 'less-powerful' devices

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

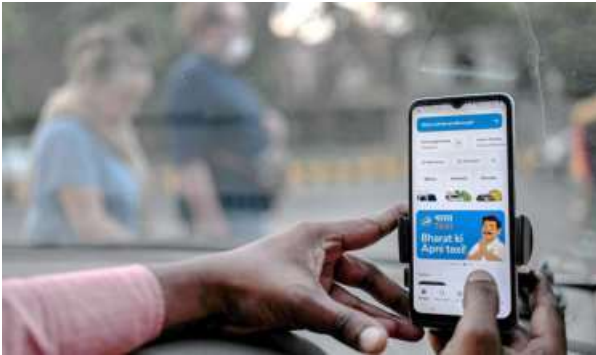
As smartphone prices increase due to a spike in demand for memory chips by AI companies and data centres, phone retailers have seen customer base dry up in a significant way.

“This is the first time I’m seeing phone prices increase, and continue increasing relentlessly, in the last 20 years,” said Vivek Singh, 42, a phone retailer in south Delhi, who has been in the business for decades. “I have 10 or 15 people coming into the shop each day, and only one or two buy a phone,” he said. Since February, phone makers have been sending retailers price hike notifications that have been progressively growing.

The Hindu obtained such notifications from Vivo, Samsung, Realme, Oppo, Nothing, Poco, and Xiaomi from the All India Mobile Retailers Association (AIMRA).

Price hikes have ranged from ₹1,000 to ₹5,000, but that is only the latest tranche. “People ask me for ₹10,000 phones, but there is no such thing any more,” Mr. Singh rued, noting that some budget handsets’ prices have more than doubled.

The results of these



Pocket unfriendly: Price hikes have ranged from ₹1,000 to ₹5,000, but that is only the latest tranche. AFP

hikes have not been completely doom and gloom just yet, at least not yet.

Kailash Lakhyani, AIMRA's founder chairman, told *The Hindu* that retailers were beginning to see better prices for pre-owned phones they got during trade-in purchases, and that retailers who had already purchased stock at an old dealer price were benefiting from a higher margin at newer prices.

A review of price hike notifications showed that some retailers saw their margins jump from 3.85% to over 14% for some Samsung phones. “60% of phones are being purchased overall,” Mr. Lakhyani claimed. “20% of customers are settling for less powerful phones, or buying second hand, and the 20% of customers below that are waiting for the festival season hoping for

discounts,” he added. “There’s also a rumour of a GST cut for smartphones, so some customers are waiting for that,” he said. The GST for smartphones stands at 18%. But this situation may worsen. “We have been in touch with phone companies, and they say this situation may go on till 2028 or even 2030,” Mr. Lakhyani said. “Next year also there will be hikes, but it may be more like a plane rather than a rocket [like this year was],” he added.

The phenomenon is global, as the memory chip crunch created by AI demand has hit electronics supply chains across the board. “Global sub-\$200 smartphone shipments are forecast to fall -40% between 2025 and 2030,” Counterpoint Research, a smartphone sales analyst firm, said on Thursday.

Economy resilient with downside risks from West Asia conflict: RBI bulletin

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI), in its monthly bulletin released late on Friday, stated that the Indian economy had stayed resilient despite global uncertainties rising from the West Asia crisis.

“The escalation of conflict in West Asia in September has led to a sharp increase in crude oil prices, reigniting concerns of a further disruption in global supply chains and build-up of inflationary pressures,” the RBI stated.

Pressure on finances

“Alongside, the rise in sovereign yields in some of the major advanced economies has put pressure on government finances. Despite such a challenging global environment, the Indian economy recorded a strong GDP growth in Q1:2026-27,” it said.

“High-frequency indicators through August reflected sustained demand with segments of industry and services sectors displaying resilience,” the RBI added in the bulletin.

The central bank further flagged inflationary tendencies in the economy transmitting as crude prices have begun increasing again. “Headline CPI inflation picked up in August 2026. Core inflation excluding precious metals has also increased from ultra-low levels of recent



The central bank flagged inflationary tendencies in the Indian economy.

months,” the RBI said.

Commenting on the foreign exchange reserves, the regulator said that the special deposit scheme for non-resident Indians (NRIs) led to a record high reserve position of \$766 billion as of September 18, 2026.

“The reserves provided cover for 11.2 months of goods imports [as on September 18] and more than 100% of the external debt outstanding as at end March 2026,” the RBI stated in the bulletin.

FCNR B flows also led to an increase in system liquidity, which has resulted in quickening deposit growth potentially supporting the ongoing credit growth cycle. On the external front, the RBI said that India's financial and external sectors drew strength from the real economy, despite geopolitical tensions and weather-related uncertainties are acting as key downside risks.

Power plants may blend imported coal with domestic supplies

Reuters
NEW DELHI

India is considering telling power plants to blend imported coal with domestic supplies for the first time since 2024, three government sources said, to ease a supply crunch that has pushed monthly spot power prices to their highest since 2022.

Higher global coal demand and rising freight costs are set to make imports costlier, as Indonesian prices are up about a fifth since May while Russian prices are 14% higher and South African rates are up 19%, traders say.

5% blending

Under the plan being discussed by the officials of the power ministry, thermal power plants would have to blend up to 5% imported coal with domestic coal, said the sources, who are directly aware of the matter.

The plan represents a sharp reversal in New Delhi's drive to boost domestic coal production and curb imports, which helped prune overseas supplies over the past two years.

Most of India's coal-fired power plants rely primarily on domestic coal, but can blend up to 15% imported coal.

Indian coal imports are already at a 15-month high.

The government's previous coal-blending directives ran from December 2021 to March 2024.

Tea production slips, shipments decline in January-July 2026

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

India's tea production declined 1.7% year-on-year (YoY) to 658.3 million kg during January-July this year, according to data shared by the United Planters' Association of Southern India (UPASI).

While the country's tea output in 2025 had grown 7.1% YoY, production during the first seven months of this year saw pressure across major tea-growing regions. Output in South India declined 4.4% and production in North India fell 0.9% largely due to climatic conditions linked to changing weather patterns. India's tea exports shrank 16.1% YoY to 128.56 million kg between January and July this year.

Meanwhile, the Tea Board of India's newly launched Tea Mark certification programme has gained initial traction, with 25 producers and mini factories receiving certification so far. The initiative, introduced in July, aims to promote speciality teas produced by small tea growers and bought-leaf factories by enhancing quality standards, branding and market access.

Tesla drives growth with sixth India Experience Centre in Tamil Nadu

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tesla India on Friday opened its sixth Experience Centre in the country here, expanding retail and after-sales presence in Tamil Nadu.

The firm also started service and body-shop operations here taking the network in India to eight locations.

“We already have experience centers in Mumbai, Gurugram, Delhi, Hyderabad, Bangalore and now, we are in Chennai,” said Sharad Agarwal, Tesla India's head.

Tesla said the Chennai Experience Centre would provide local consultation, test drives and vehicle delivery support.

The company has also



Going global: The experience centre would offer local consultation, test drives and vehicle delivery support. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

made available Tesla-approved collision centre and service capabilities at Poonamallee, providing access to genuine Tesla parts, trained technicians, software-aware diagnostics and collision repair.

“We have built the capability to establish a home charging network anywhere in this country -- in any city or state. And we are already delivering across the country. We have delivered Tesla in more than 21 States,” he said.

Tesla now has five Supercharging stations in India and is also expanding destination charging and home charging infrastructure.

ture, Mr. Agarwal said. The firm follows a direct-to-consumer model, allowing customers to order vehicles without visiting an Experience Centre. Tesla offers Model Y Premium Rear-Wheel Drive at ₹50.89 lakh with a ‘range of up to 500 km.’

The three-row, six-seat Model YL starts at ₹61.99 lakh with a ‘range of up to 681 km.’

Tesla vehicles have no prescribed maintenance schedule, he claimed. Over 70% problems can be resolved remotely.

Tesla also introduced Grok AI in its cars.

“With Grok AI, you can control a lot of features inside the car. You no longer have to touch and find the features. You sit and give the command,” he said.

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
e Procurement Tender Notice No.: 38/2026-27/SE/WS&S-M/EE/1/WS&S-M/DB/DT: 24-09-2026

1. No. of Works	: 1 No
2. Value of Works	: Rs.164.61 Lakhs
3. Downloading Starting Date	: 25-09-2026
4. Downloading ending date	: 28-09-2026 @ 4.00 PM
5. Last date of bid submission	: 28-09-2026 @ 4.30 PM
6. Date of PQ Opening	: 28-09-2026 @ 5.00 PM
7. Date of Commercial Opening	: 29-09-2026 @ 5.00 PM

Note: For any other details required in respect of above tender notice, please contact EE-I(WS) before applying for tender schedules and visit website @ www.aeprocurement.gov.in.

For Commissioner

PUNJAB STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
SCO 74-75, Bank Square, Sector-17B Chandigarh
PBX: 0172-5197847, 5197846

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

PSWC invites online tenders through GeM Portal for creation of 0.70 LMT godown capacity at 01 location in the State of Punjab for guaranteed lease of 10 years on Build, Own and Operate / Lease basis for storage requirements of FCI under two bid system 'Technical Bid' and 'Financial Bid'.
NIT (alongwith GeM Bid IDs) is available on Department's website i.e. <https://pswc.in>

PSWC reserves the right to scrap the tender at any stage without assigning any reason and PSWC will not be held liable for any costs and consequences incurred by the intending bidders.

Note: Any corrigendum(s) / Notification (s) to this Notice Inviting E-Tender shall be published Department's website & GeM Portal.

1004/12/2026-27/15586**Managing Director, PSWC**

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd., VS, VIJAYAWADA-520004
(A Govt. of A.P Undertaking)

TENDER ID: 993206

APGENCO invites Competitive Bids (in Two Parts) on AP e-Procurement platform from eligible bidders for "Lifting of 1.0 MMT of raw coal from M/s SCCL Naini Coal Mine and transportation of raw coal from SCCL Naini pithead to any of the nearest railway siding by Road mode, stacking and loading of raw coal into railway wagons from siding and delivery to Dr.NITTPS".
Schedule available Date & Time : **24.09.2026** - 20.00 Hrs onwards
Bid submission Closing Date & Time : **15.10.2026** - 15.00 Hrs
For other details visit the website: <https://tender.aeprocurement.gov.in>
DIPR 5459PP/CL, Dt: 25/09/2026

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, PHED, REGION AJMER
PHONE NO. 0145-2624748 Email-aceregionajmer@gmail.com
No. F.(J)/Ar.MP/2026-2027/ 10353-10402 Dated :23.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS FOR WORKS

Bids for the Work of Augmentation and Rehabilitation of UWSS Ajmer, District Ajmer including 5 years of O&M after 01 year Defect Liability period Under AMRUT 2.0 (NIT No. **06/2026-27**; Estimated Cost Rs.13107.47 Lacs) are invited from interested bidders up to 28.10.2026 Other particulars of the Bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state.
UBN No. PHE2627WLOB05681
NIB No. PHE2627A2709

(Jagdish Prasad Sharma)
Additional Chief Engineer
PHED, Region, Ajmer

DIPR/C/16460/2025-26

Government of India, Department of Space
Indian Space Research Organisation
LIQUID PROPULSION SYSTEMS CENTRE
Valiamala.P.O., Thiruvananthapuram-695 547

Advertisement No. LPSC/03/2026 dated 26/09/2026

Applications are invited for the following posts for LPSC Valiamala near Thiruvananthapuram.

Post No.	Discipline	No. of vacancies	Essential requirements
Scientist / Engineer-'SC' [Level 10 (Pay Matrix : ₹56,100/- - ₹1,77,500/-)]			
820	Welding	01	1. B.E./B Tech in any of the following: Mechanical / Production / Metallurgy / Manufacturing / Material Science AND 2. M.E./M Tech in any of the following: Welding Technology / Mechanical Welding and Sheet Metal Engg. / Manufacturing (with welding as one of the subjects) / Metallurgy (with welding as one of the subjects) / Production (with welding as one of the subjects)
821	Turbo Machinery	01	1. B.E./B Tech in any of the following: Mechanical / Aerospace AND 2. M.E./M Tech in any of the following: Turbo Machinery / Thermal & Fluids Engg. (with Turbo Machinery as one of the subjects) / Aerospace Propulsion (with Turbo Machinery as one of the subjects)
822	Power Electronics	01	1. B.E./B Tech in any of the following: Electronics & Communication / Electronics & Instrumentation / Applied Electronics / Electrical & Electronics / Electrical / Avionics / Power Engg. AND 2. M.E./M Tech in any of the following: Power Electronics / Power Electronics and Control / Power Control and Drives / Advanced Electrical Power System / Electrical and Electronics (Power Systems) / High Voltage and Power Systems Engg. / Industrial Power Control and drives

Note: The educational qualification (B.E./B.Tech/M.E./M.Tech) should have been completed within the stipulated duration of the course as prescribed by the University.
Age limit as on 13.10.2026 is 30 years for all posts. Ex-Servicemen, Departmental candidates and Persons With Benchmark Disabilities (PWBD) are eligible for upper age relaxation as per Govt. of India orders. Applications will be received **only through on-line**. Interested candidates may visit the website www.lpsc.gov.in for detailed information and filling-up on-line application form. For this purpose, the on-line recruitment portal will be available **from 1400 hrs on 29.09.2026 to 1400 hrs on 13.10.2026**.

BLAZING TO GLORY

Puripol smashes own Games record to win the 100m gold



REUTERS

Thailand's Puripol Boonson broke his own Asian Games record to win men's 100m in 9.90s. Puripol's semifinal run of 9.91s had eclipsed the 9.92s set by China's Su Bingtian in 2018. The Thai shaved another 100th off that in the final to finish well clear of the Omani pair of Ali Al-Balushi (10.04s) and Malham Al-Balushi (10.11s).

AMAZING RUN

China's Chen bests Singapore's Shanti for women's 100m title



AFF

China's Chen Yujie won the women's 100m in an Asian Games record (11.06s) to push Hangzhou gold medallist, Singapore's Shanti Pereira (11.21s), to silver. Bahrain's Edidiong Odiong took bronze in 11.33s. Chen's exploits were watched by a sparse crowd, with the Mizuho Park Stadium only about a quarter full.

NO STOPPING HIM

China's Zhang wins record seventh Asiad swimming gold medal



REUTERS

Chinese teenager Zhang Zhanshuo won a record seventh swimming gold at the Asian Games on Friday and said that it was the "perfect conclusion" to his week in Tokyo. The 19-year-old wrapped up a scintillating campaign with victory in 400m freestyle in a Games record time of three minutes, 41.28 seconds.

JOY AND DESPAIR

Sachin reaches quarterfinals, Preeti knocked out in last-16



FILE PHOTO

India's Sachin Siwach advanced to the men's 60kg quarterfinals with a 4-1 win over Jordan's Mohammad Adnan Abu Jajeh at the Asian Games in Nishio on Friday. Preeti Pawar, who had received a first-round bye, went down 0-5 in an unanimous verdict to North Korea's Pang Chol in a women's 54kg round-of-16 contest.

Suruchi and Kamaljeet end wait for shooting gold

The Indian pair produces a new Asian and Games record in the 10m air pistol mixed team event; the men's 50m rifle 3P team of Tomar, Niraj and Rudrankksh bags silver behind China



Double delight: Suruchi and Kamaljeet won the gold with a record-breaking effort while Rudrankksh, Tomar and Niraj did enough to land a silver. R.V. MOORTHY

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

India's wait for a shooting gold from the Aichi General Shooting Range finally ended on the sixth day of the competition. Suruchi Phogat and Kamaljeet combined to not only win the 10m air pistol mixed team event but also set a new Asian and Games record in the process. Suruchi and Kamaljeet, having both shot ordinary scores in their respective individual events, made up for the disappointment as a team, totalling 484.6 points in the final. Suruchi, in particular, was in fine form and was largely responsible for keeping India ahead right from the start, first in the qualifying round and then in the final. Suruchi shot a series of 99, 97 and a perfect 100 in the qualifying to total 296, the highest by any shooter, while Kamaljeet tried to keep pace with a 291. In the final round, Suruchi again kept getting as close to the middle as possible, consistently scoring in high 10s for 245.7 points.

Kamaljeet could only manage 238.9 but together it was enough for gold and a new record. Desperate to win Suruchi and Kamaljeet, both making their maiden continental appearance, propped up each other to break the shooting gold drought. They revealed that the individual disappointments had made them desperate. "I was really upset and sad after the individual event. I had never expected to score so less – it was almost 20 below my average, it was unacceptable, especially in qualification. "I realised something was wrong. Samresh (Jung) sir said it wasn't in our control and that there was another chance in the mixed team. He keeps telling us that you are a true athlete only when you manage to go back up after being down." Kamaljeet, who failed to make it to the final by a single point a day before, was more candid. "I thought I had another chance to go back with a medal. It is not difficult to be mentally ready," he declared. India has already lost three of the seven golds it won in shooting last time around, although Friday's win made up for it a little. However, the 22-medal haul from Hangzhou now looks a far shot. One of those golds that India failed to defend was in the men's 50m rifle 3-positions team event, where it finished with a silver. Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar, the joint owner of the qualifying Games record of 591, could only manage a 589. Niraj Kumar and Rudrankksh Patil shot 588 and 585, respectively, as the Indian trio managed a combined score of 1762, four behind China. Tomar, also the Asian record holder and Niraj, however, disappointed in the individual event, finishing fifth and eighth respectively. Far from convincing Tomar, silver medallist in the previous edition, was far from convincing, struggling to find his rhythm and the target in all three positions. With several of his shots scoring only nines, the 25-year-old had 102.9 in kneeling and 102.4 in prone for the first two rounds to trail top-placed and eventual champion Liu Yukun of China by 3.2 points.

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Friday: **Athletics:** Women's shot put final: Manpreet (bronze), Krishna (fifth); Women's pole vault final: Baranica (bronze); Women's 400m: Kiran (second in heat 2) and Prachi (third in heat 3), both qualified for the final; Women's heptathlon: Pooja (sixth), Anamika (eighth). Men's 10,000m final: Gulveer (silver); Men's 400m: Vishal (first in heat 2), qualified for the final; Men's 100m semifinals: Gurindervir (11th overall) and Animesh (18th overall), both DNQ for final; Men's hammer throw final: Damneet (ninth), Praveen (11th). **Badminton:** First round: Women: Unnati bt Yu (PRK) 2-0; Doubles: Gayatri & Treesa bt Tsang and Lui (Hkg) 2-1; Kavipriya & Simran lost to Kusuma & Puspitasari (Ina) 0-2. Men: Doubles: Satwiksairaj & Chirag lost to Pakkapon & Peeratchai (Tha) 1-2; Hariharan & Arjun lost to Fajar & Shohibul (Ina) 0-2. Mixed doubles: Dhruv & Tanisha bt Aminath & Nibal (Mdv) 2-0. **Boxing:** Round-of-16: Men's 60kg: Sachin bt Jajeh (Jor). Women's 54kg: Preeti lost to Mi (PRK). **Equestrian:** Dressage team final: Fourth (Shruti, Hriday, Gaurav, Jai). **Fencing:** Table-of-16: Men's foil team: lost to Hong Kong 27-45; Women's epee team: lost to Uzbekistan 29-45. **Hockey:** Women (Pool B): bt Japan 3-1. **Kabaddi:** Semifinals: Women: bt Nepal 48-24; Men: bt Thailand 66-28. **Shooting:** 10m air pistol mixed team final: Suruchi & Kamaljeet (gold); 50m rifle 3P men individual final: Aishwary Pratap (fifth), Niraj (eighth); Team final: Silver (Aishwary Pratap, Niraj, Rudrankksh). **Squash:** Quarterfinals: Men: Abhay bt Tsukue (Jpn) 3-0; Veer lost to Irfan (Pak) 1-3. Women: Anahat bt Tanvi 3-0; Mixed doubles: Velavan & Joshna bt Pelino & Aribado (Phi) 2-0. **Swimming:** Men: 200m backstroke final: Rishabh (sixth), Utkarsh (seventh); 200m butterfly final: Sajjan (seventh); 50m breaststroke: Danush (21st overall), DNQ for final; 400m freestyle: Aneesh (17th overall) and Dhakshan (18th overall), both DNQ for final. **Table tennis:** Mixed doubles: Semifinals: Manush & Diya lost to Wang & Sun (Chn) 0-4, bagged bronze. Quarterfinals: Harmeet & Yashaswini lost to Lin & Kuai (Chn) 0-3. Men: Round 2: Manush bt Faraji (Iri) 4-0; Manav lost to Ryong (PRK) 2-4. Women: Round 2: Yashaswini bt Zaza (Syr) 4-1; Sreeja lost to Gyong (PRK) 1-4. **Weightlifting:** Women's 61kg final: Nirupama (seventh).

SNAPSHOTS

Manush-Diya duo wins mixed doubles bronze India's Manush Shah and Diya Chitale finished with a bronze in the table tennis mixed doubles event after losing to China's Wang Chuqin and Sun Yingsha 8-11, 5-11, 8-11, 2-11 in the semifinals on Friday. In the quarters, Manush and Diya had stunned the World No. 4 duo of Doo Hoi Kem and Wong Chun Ting of Hong Kong 11-6, 13-15, 11-9, 11-5.

Iran, which beat Chinese Taipei in both the semifinal clashes. **Three medals assured in squash** Indian squash players assured themselves of three medals as Joshna Chinappa and Velavan Senthilkumar entered the mixed doubles semifinals while Anahat Singh and Abhay Singh advanced to the last four in singles.

Satwik-Chirag pair suffers shock defeat Defending men's doubles champions Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty suffered a shock opening-round exit while the mixed combination of Tanisha Crasto and Dhruv Kapila progressed to the quarterfinals with back-to-back wins. The Thailand duo of Pakkapon Teeraratsakul and Peeratchai Sukphun defeated Satwiksairaj and Chirag 12-21, 21-19, 21-14.



Fine show: Manush and Diya secured India's first TT medal at the ongoing Games. FILE PHOTO: R. RAVINDRAN

Gulveer secures a silver; Baranica makes history in pole vault; bronze for Manpreet



Stealing the show: Gulveer bettered his bronze from Hangzhou in 10,000m while Baranica became the first Indian pole vaulter to win an Asiad medal. Shot putter Manpreet came up with a 17.17m throw to earn a spot on the podium. R.V. MOORTHY

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

It needs a touch of magic to share the spotlight with Gulveer Singh's incredible consistency. On Friday, Baranica Elangovan managed to do so, soaring high and leaping into history as the first ever Indian to win an Asian Games medal in pole vault. The 29-year-old cleared a height of 4.15m to take joint bronze with Polina Ivanova of Kazakhstan at

the Paloma Mizuho athletics stadium here. It was nowhere close to her best, but it was enough to add India's third medal from track and field on day two of the competition after Manpreet Kaur captured bronze in shot put and Gulveer bettered his own performance with a silver in the 10,000m. Birhanu Balew of Bahrain won the gold (28:27.51s). The other two are events that India has done reasonably well in the past.

Pole vault, meanwhile, is an outlier in Indian athletics; women's vaulting even more. Sindhushree, however, had a disappointing outing, ending with no mark against her name. Gulveer, on the other hand, has redefined consistency. As much as Nee-raj Chopra has been the poster boy of athletics, Gulveer comes close, in terms of performances if not necessarily in medals. On Friday, the 28-year-

old added yet another achievement to his kitty, winning silver in 28:29.38, improving on his bronze from three years ago. The timing was far from his personal or even season's best but it hardly mattered. He could be in action three more times through the next few days, starting with the 1500m heats on Saturday followed by the final and the 5000m. Manpreet managed a best throw of 17.17m in her

fourth attempt to end up on the podium behind the Chinese pair of Song Jiayuan (19.40) and Zhang Linru (18.14). Krishna Jayasankar came fifth with a best of 16.57m. Damneet Singh was ninth in hammer throw with 67.56 while Praveen Kumar threw 65.24 to finish 11th. Kiran Pahal (53.44s) and Prachi (53.46) advanced to the final of the 400m, as did Vishal T.K. (45.27) among the men.

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Saturday (all times IST): **Athletics:** Men's marathon final (Sawan, Kartik), 4 a.m.; Men's decathlon, 5.30 a.m. onwards; Men's 200m heats (Animesh), 8 a.m.; semifinals, 4.50 p.m.; Women's long jump qualification (Shaili, Ancy), 8.10 a.m.; Women's 100m hurdles heats (Jyothi, Nandhini), 4 p.m.; Women's 200m heats (Unnathi, Harita), 4.25 p.m.; Men's shot put final (Tajinderpal, Karanveer), 4.30 p.m.; Men's triple jump final (Praveen, Karthik), 5 p.m.; Men's 1500m heats (Gulveer, Yoonus), 5.20 p.m.; Women's 400m final (Kiran, Prachi), 6.15 p.m.; Men's 400m final (Vishal), 6.30 p.m.; Women's 1500m final (Parul, Pooja), 6.45 p.m. **Badminton:** 2nd round: Men: Lakshya vs. Yew (Sgp), 6 a.m.; Women (not before 11.30 a.m.): Unnati vs. Ching (Mas); Doubles (not before 2.30 p.m.): Treesa & Gayatri vs. Mayu & Yuki (Jpn). **Boxing:** Last-16: Men's 55kg: Jadumani vs. Paalam (Phi), 10.15 a.m.; Men's 90kg: Kapil vs. Estaki (Iri), 2.15 p.m.; Women's 60kg: Priya vs. Yeonji (Kor), 5.45 p.m. **Hockey:** Men (Pool A): vs. Japan, 1.30 p.m. **Kabaddi:** Finals: Women: vs. Iran, 9.30 a.m.; Men: vs. Iran, 2.30 p.m. **Shooting:** 50m rifle 3P women individual qualification and team final (Tilottama, Ashi, Vidarsa), 6.15 a.m.; individual final, 9.30 a.m. **Squash:** Semifinals: Mixed doubles: Velavan & Joshna vs. Yi & Hong (Hkg), 8.30 a.m.; Women: Anahat vs. Watanabe (Jpn), 10.30 a.m.; vs. Abhay vs. Irfan (Pak), 11.15 a.m. **Table tennis:** Women (round 3): Yashaswini vs. Harimoto (Jpn), 6.30 a.m.

INBRIEF



Mercedes' Russell takes pole for Azerbaijan GP

Mercedes' George Russell produced a superb performance in qualifying on Friday to take pole position for the Azerbaijan GP while his teammate and World championship leader Kimi Antonelli crashed and will start 16th. McLaren's Oscar Piastri and Red Bull's Isack Hadjar fill the second row of the grid ahead of Lando Norris, fifth in the second McLaren.

Kusal Mendis and Wellalage the stars of Lanka's victory

Kusal Mendis struck a century while left-arm spinner Dunith Wellalage bagged three top-order wickets as Sri Lanka defeated England by 16 runs in the second ODI in Leeds to finally earn a win on its white-ball tour.

The scores: Sri Lanka 321/6 in 50 overs (Kamindu Mendis 54, Kusal Mendis 121, Rathnayake 48) bt England 305/9 in 50 overs (Banton 73, Duckett 67, Buttler 69, Jacks 52). **Toss:** Sri Lanka; **PoM:** Kusal Mendis.

Report says City found guilty of 114 Premier League charges

Manchester City has been found guilty of all but one of 115 Premier League charges it faces for breaching financial regulations, the *Athletic* reported on Friday. No sanction had yet been decided and that City is set to appeal.

Coimbatore beats Tirupur, clinches under-23 title

Host Coimbatore scored a three-wicket win over Tirupur in the final of the TNCA under-23 inter-district cricket tournament on Friday.

The scores (final): Tirupur 94 in 32.1 overs (Suyash Dwivedi 4/25, Thasish Kannan 3/22) lost to Coimbatore 96/7 in 38.3 overs (S. Pavish 3/16). **Note:** Revised target 94 in 45 overs, Coimbatore won by VJD method.

LIVE TELECAST

▼

Cricket: Asian Games (Men), Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.

Formula One: Azerbaijan GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & Fan-Code, 6.30 p.m.

Football: Nations League, Sony Sports Ten 1, 2, 5 & LIV, 9.30 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Sunday)

Asian Games: Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Sunday)

India lets Panama off the hook in draw

Williams hands the home team the lead before a thunderous left-footed strike from Valencia restores parity for the visitor in the second half

FOOTBALL

Ashwin Achal
BENGALURU

The Indian football team was on the brink of pulling off a mighty upset. That was until a thunderous strike brought the home side back to earth. Taking on significantly higher-ranked Panama at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium in an international friendly here on Friday, India looked on course for a memorable victory after Ryan Williams gave it a 1-0 lead in the 41st minute. There was a sense of disbelief, mixed with elation, as India continued to dominate. Panama, boasting World Cup pedigree, looked completely out of

sorts. It was left to Panama substitute Omar Valencia to pull the visitor out of the hole. Against the run of play, Valencia unleashed fierce a left-footed strike from well outside the box, leaving custodian Gurpreet Singh Sandhu stranded. The 68th-minute goal saved Panama, ranked 44th in the world, from an embarrassing defeat. India, ranked 138th, continued to attack without fear, but could not find a second goal. Admittedly, this was not Panama's strongest team, with only two players in the starting XI – Cesar Blackman and Tomas Rodriguez – having featured at the World Cup earlier this year. It was, nevertheless, a spirited performance from the Indians, who consis-

tently created the better chances. The deadlock was broken when a defensive lapse allowed Williams to run through with only the goalkeeper to beat. A cool finish from the forward sent the loud crowd into a frenzy. Ecstasy turned to silence later when Valencia produced his stunner, but the home faithful remained engaged thanks to the relentlessly aggressive Indians. Edmund Lalrindika came closest to securing a match-winner, but missed from close range in the dying minutes. Manvir Singh fluffed a backheel, allowing Panama to escape with pride intact. **The result:** India 1 (Williams 41) drew with Panama 1 (Valencia 68).



The poacher: Williams showcased his goal-scoring ability yet again. K. MURALI KUMAR

Gukesh's brilliance helps India pip Germany; women crush Uzbekistan

CHESS OLYMPIAD

Sports Bureau



Contrasting day: Gukesh posted a crucial win for India while his World championship challenger Sindarov faced defeat. FIDE

Important results (ninth round): Open: India bt Germany 2.5-1.5 (R. Praggnanandhaa drew with Vincent Keymer; Arjun Erigaisi drew with Matthias Bluebaum; Nihal Sarin drew with Frederik Svane; D. Gukesh bt Alexander Donchenko) Uzbekistan bt USA 2.5-1.5; China drew with France 2-2; Uzbekistan (2) bt Netherlands 3.5-0.5; Armenia bt Azerbaijan 2.5-1.5; Hungary bt Austria 3-1; Ukraine bt Georgia 2.5-1.5; Spain bt Czech Republic 3-1; Bulgaria drew with Turkiye 2-2; Brazil drew with Greece 2-2. **Women: India bt Uzbekistan 3-1** (Koneru Humpy drew with Afruza Khמדamova; Divya Deshmukh bt Gulrukhbegim Tokhirjonova; Vantika Agrawal bt Nilufarkhon Imomkuzieva; B. Savitha Shri drew with Guldona Karimova). China bt Armenia 3-1; Kazakhstan drew with Mongolia; Georgia drew with Greece; France bt Serbia 2.5-1.5; Poland bt Cuba 2.5-1.5; Indonesia bt Germany 2.5-1.5; Vietnam bt Bulgaria 3.5-0.5; USA bt Canada 3-1; Azerbaijan bt Czech Republic 4-0; Netherlands bt Argentina 2.5-1.5.

After a while, India had a well-nigh perfect day at the Chess Olympiad. Both the men's and women's teams won their matches in the ninth round at Samarkand on Friday. After conceding draws in the previous round, both teams had to win their matches. The men encountered a strong challenge from the giant-killer Germany before winning 2.5-1.5, while the women crushed host Uzbekistan 3-1. The Indian men owe their win to World champion D. Gukesh, who showed resilience and brilliance to defeat Alexander Donchenko on the fourth board. He came back from an inferior position and found a superb knight manoeuvre on his way to a 54-

move victory with black pieces. The other games, featuring R. Praggnanandhaa, Arjun Erigaisi and Nihal Sarin were all drawn. India has 15 points and is in joint second position in the open section, along with Uzbekistan (2) and Armenia. With 16 points, Uzbekistan is in the sole lead. Just two rounds remain. In the women's event too, India is placed second

with 15 points, alongside Kazakhstan and Mongolia. Former champion China is the sole leader with 17 points. The Indian women were too good for Uzbekistan, though B. Savitha Shri, for the first time in the tournament, failed to win. After winning all her seven games, she was forced to split the point, with Guldona Karimova, but Divya Deshmukh and Vantika Agrawal won their games.

F2000, F1600 headline MRF Challenge

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

A compact card of eight races has been framed for the second round of the MRF Indian National Racing Challenge to be held at the Madras International Circuit over the weekend. The programme will be headlined by the two MRF Formula classes, F2000 and F1600, besides the ever-popular Formula LGB 1300, which has attracted the bulk of entries.

In the inaugural round at the same venue last month, a clutch of youngsters upstaged their experienced peers. Among them is 18-year-old Saishiva Sankaran, last year's MRF F1600 champion. He delivered a dominant performance in the MRF F2000 class in the first round. However, this weekend, Saishiva will have to contend with 17-year-old Ishaan Madesh, last year's MRF F2000 champion.

ENGAGEMENTS

Basketball: Mayor Radhakrishnan Trophy first All-India basketball tournament, Nehru indoor stadium, 5 p.m. onwards.

Cricket: TNCA league, III-A, IOB vs. National RC (Tagore); Sir M.Ct.M. Old Boys vs. Ranji (Venkateswara), 9 a.m.

V-B, MRC-B vs. Chennai P&T Audit (St. Bede's-A)

IV-A, Reserve Bank vs. Book Sellers XI (Union); Purasawalkam vs.

Prasad (Wahe Guru-B); Bharathi vs. Vigneswara (Gojan, mat), 9.30 a.m.

DCAC league, II-B, GE T&D vs. RCR (8 a.m.); II-A, Asiatic CA vs. Leo (1 p.m.), GE T&D ground (Pallavaram).

Motorsports: MRF Indian National Racing Challenge 4W, second round, MIC (Sriperumbudur), 2.30 p.m.

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In F1, however, the overriding focus is fairness, for the stakes are much higher. This has led to the organisers being less bold. Once the cars clear the first-lap jeopardy, Sprints often settle into a predictable rhythm, without even the strategic differences found in the main race. While only a handful of drivers have won both the Sprint and the Grand Prix in the same weekend, there have not been many outlier winners or podium-finishers to build excitement in Sprints either.

In the junior formulas below F1,

F1's rationale for adding programmes is positive fan feedback. "Since the Sprint was

Sprints, by also offering Championship points, changed the equation. In the first two years of their existence, there was a seamless transition from one session to the next. A single



#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Abrar Ahmed	736	757
2	Rashid Khan	735	828
3	Adam Zampa	700	746
4	Adil Rashid	695	747
5	Nathan Ellis	675	678
6	Jamie Overton	674	674
7	Varun Chakravarthy	671	818
8	Mohammad Nasir	658	672
9	Wanindu Hasaranga	656	809
10	Jaspit Bumrah	651	783

PTI

●●

The new scoring system will tilt the game towards power and speed. But when that happens, chances of getting injured are higher

I will be happy as long as winners from non-cricket sports are also celebrated

Even for the trailblazing Saina Nehwal, getting into the limelight was tough in a cricket-mad country. In a free-wheeling chat, the Olympic and World championships medallist speaks on the struggle for co-existence between sports in India, the impending change to badminton's scoring system, P.V. Sindhu's future and the next generation of stars

Ashwin Achal

Saina Nehwal chuckled when asked if the 3x15 scoring system, set to come into force from January 2027, could tempt her to return to the badminton court. In theory, Saina, at least at her peak, would have revelled in this abridged format. Her natural attacking flair, speed and ability to close out games would have made her a neat fit. While this could make for a good debate over coffee, the reality is quite different. At 36, and having gone through the intense grind of the professional tour for nearly two decades, Saina is unable to meet the physical demands of the sport. “I wish I could come back, but I have total cartilage damage,” she said during a virtual interaction. “My knee is in a seriously bad shape. I cannot push for more than half an hour. But yes, I really do want to play.” Saina believes that her contemporary P.V. Sindhu will benefit from the new rules. Sindhu, 31, may be in the final stages of her career, but has plenty of fight left. In July, the double Olympic medallist served a reminder of her class by becoming the first Indian to win the Japan Open.

Merits and demerits
“The good thing is that Sindhu has the best physiotherapist and trainer. This is really helpful. Her court movement is very good,” Saina observed. “From next year, when the points system shifts to 3x15, matches will get shorter. You will get a lot of recovery time between fixtures. There are big breaks between Super 1000 tournaments too, which guarantees good rest periods. “Careers will extend longer because the matches are shorter. Any player can win tournaments in that scenario,” the two-time World championships medallist added. Saina, the first Indian woman to reach the summit in the World rankings, added a note of caution regarding training regimens.

Sindhu's court movement is very good. If she can avoid injuries, she can play for long

“The new scoring system will tilt the game towards power and speed. But when you train for power and speed, chances of getting injured are higher. If Sindhu can take care to avoid injuries, she can play for a long time,” she opined. Looking at the talent that has emerged after Saina and Sindhu, there remains a gap in quality. The likes of Unnati Hooda and Tanvi Sharma have registered some impressive wins, but are not yet world-beaters in the class of their seniors. “In terms of attitude and skill, Tanvi and Unnati have a very bright future. They have gained experience and produced results. Devika [Sihag] and the other players need to improve a bit more. “There are challenges – how do you make a comeback from a loss? How much do you train on a regular basis? Are you ready to push yourself and not give up? As far as I have seen, Tanvi and Unnati don't give up. They keep fighting. They have the best coaches too. Tanvi is training under Park [Tae-sang], while Unnati is training with her father,” Saina stated. As for the best in the world, Saina rates 2024 Paris Olympics gold medallist An Se-young as a “once in a generation” player. She had



taken on the South Korean when the latter was a promising youngster, sharing the spoils with a 1-1 head-to-head record. “An can rally very well, and the improvement now is that she dives well to pick up shots. She has also improved the speed of strokes. She is not the fastest player, but she has fast strokes and her court coverage is very smooth,” Saina said. And then there is the 24-year-old's intense drive – a trait Saina views as key. “Even after having won the Olympic gold and so many titles, you can still see that hunger to win. When she lost recently, you saw her crying. A player with that sort of desire is tough to defeat.” **Against the odds** The 2012 London Olympics bronze medallist is of the opinion that with cricket taking centrestage in India, athletes in other sports must stay at an elite level to gain recognition. “In India, the problem is that if you perform in any sport apart from cricket, you don't get much importance unless you win tournaments. Tanvi and Unnati have won tournaments, and that's why everyone is talking about them. You have to show results and win consistently. That is when you get popular in this country.” Saina, who is serving on the expert panel of *Sony Sports Network* for its coverage of the 2026 Asian Games, is hopeful that the hype around the Indian cricket teams will not overshadow other disciplines at the multi-sport extravaganza. “I will be happy as long as medal winners from other sports are [also] celebrated. We expect the Indian cricket team to win medals at the Asian Games and the Olympics. But this could mean that medallists from other sports might feel bad if they don't receive the same encouragement as the cricketers. “I have a feeling that [even] if they (non-cricket sportspersons) win a gold medal, they will get sidelined. In that scenario, I will feel bad because

only cricket gets the support,” Saina explained. The Padma Bhushan awardee reflected on the challenges she faced during her playing career, especially when it came to getting the attention of the general public. “I had to win multiple Super Series titles in a year to be there [in the spotlight]. Just one Super Series victory was not enough. I had the motivation to win an Olympic medal, and to become the World No. 1. The victories helped me appear in newspapers, and people started to notice me.” **Guts and glory** Her groundbreaking achievements were marked by self-improvement and dedication to the sport. “I worked on improving myself every day – listening to my coaches, thinking about how to prepare for the next tournament, staying injury-free... I had big goals for myself, which is why I was able to win at Super Series events and the World championships,” Saina stated. “Having said that, I also feel sad that after winning 24 international titles and an Olympic medal, many people confuse me with tennis player Sania Mirza. “I am sure that about 70 to 80% of girls in India do not know anything about the world of sports. We have to find out how we can promote sports. I am not against cricket, but other sports can never overtake cricket unless athletes keep winning at the highest level.” Saina emphasised the role of a stable support system, starting with good parenting. “To win even a couple of Super Series tournaments is very, very challenging for Indian players. If there is no financial support, we should not expect to win a single title. “When my parents took the risk to support my badminton dreams, they did not think much about the great financial rewards I may get. They just wholeheartedly supported me, and luckily I could come back with so many good results. But how many parents can do this? It's not that easy.”

GAME THEORY

Peak performance

On September 14, when Elena Rybakina took over as the new World No. 1 in women's tennis after winning the US Open, she snapped Aryna Sabalenka's 99 consecutive weeks at the pinnacle. Here is a look at the all-time best streaks at the top of the women's game

Player	Weeks
Steffi Graf	186
Serena Williams	186
Martina Navratilova	156
Ashleigh Barty	114
Chris Evert	113
Aryna Sabalenka	99
Steffi Graf	94
Monica Seles	91
Martina Navratilova	90
Steffi Graf	87
Martina Hingis	80
Chris Evert	76
Iga Swiatek	75
Martina Hingis	73
Monica Seles	64



PICTURE THIS



Bend it like Beckham

Off-beat sports are all the rage now. Didn't the 2024 Paris Olympics introduce Breaking – break dance to Indians – as a medal sport? The latest is Teqball, which debuted at the ongoing Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, and also

had an enthusiastic Indian participant in Quimcy Dsouza. Teqball is basically table tennis played with a football over a curved table, and it does appear more like a sport than Breaking ever will. And it draws more than a tinge of legitimacy from the fact that some of football's greatest names, such as Brazilian icon Ronaldo and Spain's World Cup-winning

defender Carles Puyol, are associated with it. Teqball was birthed just over a decade ago in Hungary by a former footballer and a computer scientist. They found a willing businessman to market it, and the International Teqball Federation was established in 2017. Ball control, agility and reflexes are skills directly transferable from football, and

the room it provides to plant powerful headers and overhead smashes into the table makes viewing spectacular. At times, players are completely airborne and parallel to the ground. Imagine what a highlights reel of such moments can do on social media? No wonder Puyol played a mock game in Nagoya, without a single ticket-paying fan but just influencers!